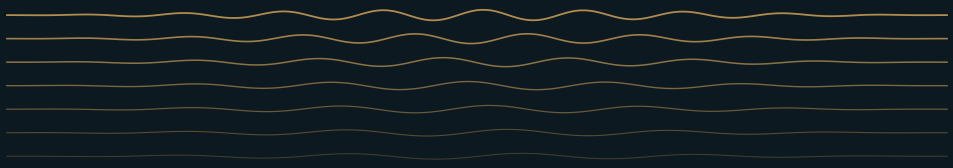
A DISSERTATION



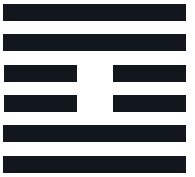
Wind over Lake

Synchronic Counterfactuality, the Autographic State, and the Fiduciary Ontology of Philip K. Dick's *The Man in the High Castle*



OCTOBER 2026

中孚



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A DISSERTATION

October 2026

Hexagram 61 · Zhongfu 中孚 · Inner Truth · wind over the lake

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Abstract

This dissertation reinterprets Philip K. Dick's *The Man in the High Castle* (1962) as a philosophical treatise in narrative form on the conditions of truth in a world that cannot authenticate itself. Against the two dominant critical paradigms—the generic, which assimilates the novel to the alternate-history tradition and its causal "point of divergence," and the metafictional, which reads the novel-within-the-novel as an exemplary instance of postmodern ontological instability—it contends that Dick's decisive innovation is the **synchronic counterfactual**: a mode of inter-world relation in which alternative histories are connected not diachronically, through a causal hinge in the past, but synchronically, through acausal correspondences (oracle, book, artefact, vision) operating within a shared present.

Reconstructing the novel's intellectual genealogy—the *Zhou Yi* and its Han and Song exegesis; Leibniz's binary reading of the hexagrams and the *Theodicy*'s pyramid of possible worlds; the colonial philology of Richard Wilhelm's Tsingtao translation and C. G. Jung's theory of synchronicity; Daoist and Chan ontologies of emptiness; and the analyses of totalitarianism advanced by Arendt, Césaire, Benjamin, Horkheimer and Adorno—the study shows that the novel stages a conflict between two regimes of historicity. The first, here designated the **autographic state** (generalising Nelson Goodman's distinction between autographic and allographic arts), grounds value and identity in provenance: in certified descent, documented origin, and blood. The novel identifies this regime with fascism and demonstrates, through its pervasive economy of forgery, that the autographic state is structurally parasitic upon the counterfeit it claims to exclude. The second regime, figured in Hexagram 61 (*Zhongfu*, "Inner Truth"), whose image is wind moving over a lake and whose graphic structure is an empty centre, grounds truth in fidelity rather than provenance.

From this opposition the dissertation derives a **fiduciary ontology**—worlds possess reality as fiduciary currency possesses value, by trust rather than by intrinsic substance—and a corresponding **ethics of fidelity without provenance**, instantiated in the novel's decisive acts of refusal and in the paradoxical *wu* of objects made by a man the Reich defines as counterfeit. A type–token analysis of the oracle's verdict resolves the novel's central crux: how a book whose facts match no world, including the reader's, can nonetheless be declared true. A final movement argues that the verdict implicates the reader's world as fully as the Axis world. Read against Tagomi's vision and against the documented absorption of Axis personnel, science, and legal models into the victors' postwar order, "Inner Truth" names not a consolation ("the Allies

won") but a summons: the war remains undecided at the level of type, whatever its outcome at the level of event. The novel is thereby repositioned as a **negative theodicy** and as the founding text of a counterfactual ethics adequate to an age of unverifiable worlds.

Prefatory Note on Method, Texts, and Transliteration

The Man in the High Castle circulates in numerous editions with divergent paginations; references are therefore to narrative episodes rather than to pages. Quotation from the novel and from other copyrighted modern sources is held to a strict minimum, and the argument proceeds by close paraphrase. Where the exact wording of an authority is load-bearing, quotation is drawn from public-domain texts: the Authorized Version (1611) for Ecclesiastes, Matthew, and Judith; James Legge for the *Yijing* (1882), the *Daodejing* and *Zhuangzi* (1891), and *Mencius*; Herbert Giles for *Zhuangzi* (1889); John Burnet for Heraclitus (1892), with Diels–Kranz numbers; J. Sibree for Hegel (1857); Robert Latta for the *Monadology* (1898); Moore and Aveling for *Capital* (1887); and the German, French, and Latin originals of Benjamin, Wagner, Pascal, Ranke, Schiller, and Augustine.

Classical Chinese is romanised in pinyin, with Wade–Giles given in brackets where it corresponds to the forms used in the Wilhelm–Baynes translation and hence in Dick (*Zhongfu* [*Chung Fu*]). Hexagrams are cited by their King Wen sequence number. Because the syllable *wu* recurs across several characters and tones in the argument of Chapter 2, characters are supplied at first mention.

Methodologically, the study practises what may be called **genealogy against provenance**. It reconstructs the sources and originators of Dick's ideas with philological care, yet it adopts from Nietzsche's and Foucault's genealogical method (Foucault 1971) the principle that descent (*Herkunft*) discloses not the inviolable identity of an origin but the disparity, accident, and contamination of what lies at the beginning of things. The genealogies of Part One are accordingly not exercises in authentication. They demonstrate, source by source, the thesis the novel itself advances: that no authority in Dick's world—not even the oracle—can secure its truth by pedigree.

INTRODUCTION

The Book That Asked Why It Was Written

I. The Final Question

The novel closes on a question that no prior work of historical fiction had thought to ask. Juliana Frink, having opened the throat of the assassin dispatched to kill Hawthorne Abendsen, reaches Cheyenne and finds that the fortified "High Castle" of rumour is an ordinary suburban house. There she learns that Abendsen composed *The Grasshopper Lies Heavy*—the banned novel in which the Allies won the Second World War—by consulting the *I Ching* at each narrative juncture. She then puts to the oracle a question addressed to the book itself: why was it written? The coins return Hexagram 61, *Zhongfu*, "Inner Truth," which Juliana construes as a verdict that Germany and Japan in fact lost the war. The novel ends without ratifying or refuting her construal.

The question rests on three presuppositions, each of which dismantles a pillar of modern literary and historical epistemology. It presupposes, first, that a book may possess a non-human author, which anticipates and radicalises the dissolution of authorship that Barthes (1967) and Foucault (1969) would theorise later in the decade. It presupposes, second, that this non-human author has an intention that can be interrogated—a reversal of the anti-intentionalism codified by Wimsatt and Beardsley (1946), since the only author whose intention may be consulted is the one that has none in the human sense. It presupposes, third, that the answer can adjudicate the reality of the world in which the question is asked. That final presupposition inverts Ranke's programmatic demand (1824) that history show *wie es eigentlich gewesen*, "how it actually was." The oracle answers instead how it inwardly is.

II. Five Paradigms and Their Common Limit

Critical reception has organised itself around five paradigms, each illuminating and each partial.

1. **The generic paradigm** situates the novel within the history of alternate history (Hellekson 2001; Rosenfeld 2005; Gallagher 2018). It rightly identifies the Zangara assassination of 1933 as the point of divergence and reads the novel as an intervention in the cultural memory of Nazism. It treats the relation between worlds, however, as fundamentally causal.

2. **The postmodern paradigm** reads the novel as a prototype of what McHale (1987) called the ontological dominant and of what Hutcheon (1988) termed historiographic metafiction. It captures the novel's self-reflexivity but tends to dissolve the oracle's verdict into a play of undecidable frames.
3. **The East–West paradigm**, inaugurated by Warrick (1980), reads the novel as an encounter between Daoism and fascism. It captures the novel's moral polarity but treats the *I Ching* as a theme rather than as a formal principle of inter-world relation.
4. **The postcolonial paradigm**, exemplified by Carter (1995), reads Robert Childan's servility through Bhabha's theory of colonial mimicry. It illuminates the political economy of the Pacific States but isolates that economy from the novel's metaphysics.
5. **The Marxist and psychoanalytic paradigm** of Suvin (1975), Freedman (1984), and Jameson (2005) reads Dick through commodity fetishism, paranoia, and the political unconscious. It illuminates the commodity form but not the specific logic of the forgery.

These paradigms share a common limit. They treat the relation between worlds either as causal (the hinge) or as merely ontological (the undecidable frame). They treat the forgery motif as thematic local colour rather than as a structural principle. And they treat the Axis world as the *other* of the reader's world rather than as its latent truth.

III. The Thesis

This dissertation advances four interlocking propositions.

Proposition 1 (formal). Dick's novel inaugurates the synchronic counterfactual. It retains a diachronic substrate (Zangara's successful shot) but subordinates it to a synchronic superstructure in which worlds communicate through acausal correspondence within a shared present. The novel is set in 1962, the year of its publication. Its alternative world is lateral to the reader's present rather than anterior to it.

Proposition 2 (political-aesthetic). The novel identifies fascism with an autographic ontology—a regime that constitutes identity through provenance, certification, and blood—and exposes that regime as structurally dependent on forgery. Wyndam-Matson's two lighters, Frank Frink's changed name, and the Reich's demand for his extradition belong to a single logic.

Proposition 3 (ontological-ethical). Against provenance, the novel proposes fidelity. Hexagram 61 names a truth that is neither correspondence to fact nor descent from an origin but trust (*fu*) between a token and its type. Worlds are real in the way fiduciary currency is valuable: by backing, not by substance. The ethical corollary is fidelity without provenance—authentic action in a world whose own authenticity cannot be certified.

Proposition 4 (historical-theological). The oracle's verdict exonerates no world. It indicts the Axis world as counterfeit, but Tagomi's vision and the historical record of the Axis remainder in the victors' order (Operation Paperclip, the Gehlen Organisation, the immunity

granted to Unit 731, the political rehabilitation of Kishi Nobusuke) extend the indictment to the reader's world. The novel is a negative theodicy: it justifies no world, only acts.

IV. Method

The method is comparative genealogical hermeneutics. It joins intellectual history (the originators of Dick's ideas), philology (the Chinese lexicon of the oracle), philosophical reconstruction (modal logic, aesthetics of forgery, political ontology), and comparative literature (the speculative and philosophical fictions that precede and follow the novel). As stated in the Prefatory Note, the genealogies proceed *against* provenance. Each of Dick's sources proves to be impure: Wilhelm's translation was produced in a German colony seized by Japan; Jung's sponsorship of the oracle coincides with his compromised conduct of the 1930s; Heidegger's turn to the *Laozi* follows his rectorate; Suzuki's Zen was entangled with Japanese militarism. These impurities are not adduced to discredit the sources. They confirm the novel's own claim that truth, if it is to be had, cannot be had by pedigree.

V. Architecture

Part One (Chapters 1–4) reconstructs the genealogies: the oracle's provenance; the Daoist, Chan, and Jungian matrix; the metaphysics of the Reich; and the lineages of counterfactual thought. Part Two (Chapters 5–9) offers readings: of historicity and the autographic state; of the novel's four economies of history; of *The Grasshopper Lies Heavy* and its nested worlds; of Tagomi's satori; and of Juliana's journey. Part Three (Chapters 10–12) articulates the theory: the synchronic counterfactual and its type–token logic; the fiduciary ontology and the ethics of fidelity without provenance; and the persistence of the Axis in the actual. The Conclusion returns to the image of Hexagram 61—wind over lake—as the emblem of a truth visible only in its effects.

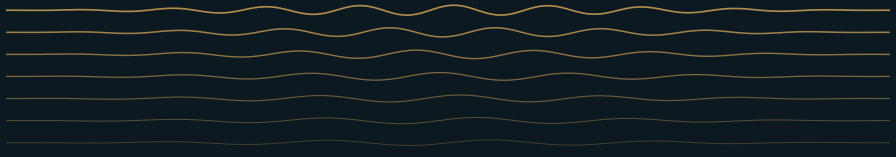
PART ONE



Genealogies

Hexagram 50 · Ding 鼎 · The Caldron

CHAPTERS 1–4



CHAPTER ONE

1 The Oracle's Provenance: *Zhou Yi*, Leibniz, Tsingtao, and the Colonial Palimpsest

THE ORACLE THAT governs the moral life of Dick's Pacific States is the most historically overdetermined object in the novel. Its descent runs from a Western Zhou divination manual through Han canonisation, Song metaphysics, a German missionary's translation made in a colony that Japan seized from Germany, a Jungian analyst's English rendering, and a Swiss psychiatrist's theory of acausality. This chapter reconstructs that descent and argues that its impurity is the first evidence for the dissertation's thesis.

1.1 The *Zhou Yi* as a Book of Times

The *Zhou Yi* comprises three strata: the sixty-four hexagram figures, the judgments attached to each (*guaci*), and the statements attached to each line (*yaoci*). The core text is generally dated to the late Western Zhou. Tradition assigns the trigrams to the culture-hero Fu Xi, the judgments to King Wen, and the line statements to the Duke of Zhou. The philosophical commentaries known as the Ten Wings (*Shiyi*), attributed to Confucius but compiled in the Warring States and early Han, transformed the manual into a cosmology. Canonisation followed when Emperor Wu established erudites for the Five Classics in 136 BCE.

The tradition locates the book's origin in captivity. King Wen, imprisoned at Youli by the last Shang tyrant, is said to have elaborated the hexagrams in confinement; his son's conquest then founded the Zhou on the doctrine of the Mandate of Heaven (*tianming*), which makes legitimacy conditional on virtue and revocable by its absence. Sima Qian, writing after his own castration at the order of Emperor Wu, opened his catalogue of works born of adversity with the formula that King Wen, imprisoned, elaborated the *Zhou Yi* (*Wen Wang ju er yan Zhou Yi*). That catalogue founds a lineage which Western tradition reproduces independently: Boethius composing the *Consolation of Philosophy* in an Ostrogothic prison (c. 524), Gramsci filling the *Prison Notebooks* in a fascist cell (1929–35), Bonhoeffer writing the letters later collected as *Widerstand und Ergebung* (1951) before his execution. Abendsen, writing under occupation and in

fear of assassination, is the fictional heir of this lineage. *The Grasshopper Lies Heavy* is a prison book whose author has been persuaded that he is free.

A second feature of the *Zhou Yi* is decisive for what follows. A hexagram does not predict an event; it characterises a *time* (*shi*, 時). The *Tuan* commentary repeatedly closes its exegesis with the formula that great indeed is the meaning of the time of a given hexagram. Each figure names a configuration of forces—a situation-type—that can be instantiated in indefinitely many concrete moments. The Han exegetical tradition, transmitted under the name of Zheng Xuan, held that the word *Yi* carries three senses: ease or simplicity (*yijian*), change (*bianyi*), and non-change (*buyi*). The third sense is the conceptual seed of Chapter 10. What does not change within change is the type; what changes is the token. A book of times is therefore a book of types, and a book of types can speak truly about moments that differ in every particular.

1.2 Leibniz's Two Discoveries

The two pillars of Dick's novel—the hexagram as combinatorial cosmos and the possible world as the object of oracular vision—meet for the first time in a single European oeuvre. In 1701 the Jesuit Joachim Bouvet, writing from the Kangxi court, sent Leibniz the circular and square arrangements of the hexagrams associated with the Song philosopher Shao Yong. Leibniz recognised in them the binary progression from zero to sixty-three and published his *Explication de l'Arithmétique Binaire* (1703), crediting Fu Xi with anticipating his own calculus of 0 and 1. Leibniz had already read binary theologically. In 1697 he proposed to Duke Rudolph August of Brunswick a medal bearing the motto *omnibus ex nihilo ducendis sufficit unum*: one suffices to derive all things from nothing. The hexagram became, in European eyes, an image of creation ex nihilo.

Seven years later, the *Essais de Théodicée* (1710) closed with a continuation of Lorenzo Valla's dialogue on free will (§§405–417). Sextus Tarquinius consults the oracle of Apollo, then Jupiter; the priest Theodorus, sleeping in the temple of Pallas at Athens, dreams of the Palace of the Fates. Its apartments form a pyramid of possible worlds, in each of which Sextus acts differently. At the apex lies the actual world, the best, in which Sextus commits the crime whose consequence is the Roman Republic. Theodorus faints before its beauty.

Leibniz's myth thus begins with an oracle, turns on a crime that founds a political order, and resolves the plurality of worlds by optimisation. Dick's novel retains the first two elements and inverts the third. The oracle is consulted by the occupied. The crime—a war of extermination—has founded the actual order. The actual is not the best of possible worlds; it is, by the oracle's verdict, not even the true one. The *Monadology* (1714) supplies the novel's ontological premise in a sentence Dick's worlds obey: "The Monads have no windows, through which anything could come in or go out" (§7, trans. Latta). Dick's worlds are windowless in the same sense. The oracle is the one aperture that pre-established harmony permits.

1.3 Tsingtao, 1914: The Colonial Philology of the Wilhelm Translation

Richard Wilhelm (1873–1930) arrived in 1899 in Tsingtao, capital of the German leased territory of Kiautschou, as a missionary of the Allgemeiner Evangelisch-Protestantischer Missionsverein. Germany had seized the bay in November 1897, after the killing of two German Catholic missionaries, and formalised a ninety-nine-year lease in March 1898. Wilhelm studied with the Qing loyalist scholar Lao Naixuan (1843–1921), with whom he began the translation of the *Yijing*. In the autumn of 1914 Japanese forces, with British support, besieged and took Tsingtao. The Treaty of Versailles transferred Germany's Shandong rights to Japan in 1919, provoking the May Fourth Movement, and Japan restored the province to China only in 1922.

The translation that resulted, *I Ging: Das Buch der Wandlungen*, appeared in 1924 from Eugen Diederichs of Jena, a house whose programme of neo-Romantic and *völkisch*-adjacent renewal placed it near the centre of Weimar's conservative revolution. The consequence for the novel is structural. The oracle that partitions the consciousness of Dick's characters was itself made at the seam of the two empires that partition his geography. A German translation produced in a Chinese territory contested by Germany and Japan becomes, in an America partitioned by Germany and Japan, the instrument by which the occupied learn that the partition is false.

1.4 Cary Fink Baynes and "Mr. Baynes"

Wilhelm's German was rendered into English by Cary F. Baynes (1883–1977), Jung's translator and associate, for the Bollingen Series, named after Jung's tower and financed by Paul and Mary Mellon; it appeared in 1950 as Bollingen Series XIX. Critics have long noted that Dick gave the name "Baynes" to the cover identity of Captain Rudolf Wegener of the Abwehr, who travels to San Francisco as a Swedish industrialist to warn the Japanese of Operation Dandelion, the planned German nuclear strike on the Home Islands.

Less often observed is that the translator was born Cary Fink. Her full name thus divides between two of Dick's characters: "Fink" is the birth name that Frank Frink, a Jew, has altered in order to survive, and "Baynes" is the name under which Wegener conducts his treason against the Reich. Whether Dick knew the translator's birth name cannot be documented, and it is treated here as a synchronicity rather than an allusion. Either way, the onomastics make the translator a double agent and translation a form of espionage, as the Italian proverb *traduttore, traditore* had always implied.

The Abwehr itself carries historical charge. Under Admiral Wilhelm Canaris, German military intelligence sheltered the core of the conservative resistance. Canaris, Hans Oster, and Dietrich Bonhoeffer—who had served the Abwehr as cover—were hanged together by the SS at Flossenbürg on 9 April 1945, after a summary court-martial. Wegener's mission is the fictional

prolongation of that resistance into a world in which it never ended because the war ended otherwise.

1.5 Jung's Foreword and the Book That Answers for Itself

Jung's foreword to the 1950 edition supplies two elements the novel absorbs. The first is the theory: the oracle operates not by causality but by synchronicity, the meaningful coincidence of a psychic state and an external event, so that the fall of the coins indexes the total character of a moment. Jung developed the concept fully in his essay on synchronicity as an acausal connecting principle (1952), published with Wolfgang Pauli's study of Kepler.

The second element is a gesture. Jung personified the book and consulted it about the advisability of his own foreword, asking how it regarded its presentation to the Western public. He received Hexagram 50, *Ding* (the Caldron), which he read as the book's self-description as a vessel of spiritual nourishment. This is the direct precedent for Juliana's question. Jung asked the oracle, through itself, about a book; Juliana asks the oracle, through itself, about a book the oracle wrote. Dick's final scene literalises the rhetorical figure of Jung's foreword and raises its stakes from the reception of a text to the reality of a world.

1.6 The Impure Oracle

The *I Ching* that Dick's characters cast is therefore a palimpsest: a Zhou manual, canonised by Han imperial ideology, systematised by Song metaphysics, translated by a German missionary in a colony with the help of a Qing loyalist, published by a *völkisch*-adjacent press, rendered into English by an American Jungian, framed by a Swiss psychiatrist whose conduct in the 1930s remains contested, financed by American industrial capital, and popularised in the countercultural Bay Area in which Dick wrote. No object in the novel possesses so dense and so mixed a historicity. None would fare worse under the certificate logic that Wyndam-Matson articulates. If the oracle speaks truly, it does so in spite of its pedigree. That is the novel's first lesson in fidelity without provenance.

CHAPTER TWO

Way, Void, and Synchronicity: The Daoist, Chan, and Jungian Matrix

The novel's metaphysics is assembled from three Asian and one European source: the *Laozi*'s logic of reversal, the *Zhuangzi*'s undecidable dreamer, the Chan/Zen practice of awakening, and Jung's theory of acausal meaning. This chapter reconstructs each and isolates the philological crux on which the novel's ethics turns: the word *wu*.

2.1 The *Laozi* and the Logic of Reversal

The governing law of the *Laozi* is reversal (*fan*, 反). In Legge's rendering of chapter 40: "The movement of the Tao / By contraries proceeds; / And weakness marks the course / Of Tao's mighty deeds." Applied to history, the principle entails that the moment of maximal strength is the moment at which decline begins. The Axis world of 1962 is such a moment: Tagomi's meditations and Wegener's despair both register that the Reich's triumph is already the configuration of its exhaustion.

The *taijitu*, the diagram of the Supreme Ultimate systematised by Zhou Dunyi in the eleventh century, gives the principle its most economical image: each field contains a seed of its opposite. The dissertation adopts the figure as a structural key. *The Grasshopper Lies Heavy* is the dark seed in the light field of the Axis world; Chapter 12 will argue that the reader's world carries an Axis seed in its own field.

Three further chapters of the *Laozi* supply the novel's ethics of the small. Chapter 11 locates use in emptiness: the hub's void makes the wheel turn, the hollow makes the vessel, and "what has a (positive) existence serves for profitable adaptation, and what has not that for (actual) usefulness" (Legge). Chapter 63 counsels doing what is great while it is small. Chapter 78 observes that nothing is softer than water, yet nothing surpasses it in attacking the hard. The ethics of *wu wei* (無為) that follows is not passivity but action attuned to the configuration of a situation—what François Jullien has analysed as the efficacy of *shi* (勢), the propensity of things, against the European model of an end imposed on matter by will (Jullien 1992). The Reich's *Wille* and the Daoist *wu wei* are the novel's antithetical theories of agency.

2.2 The Butterfly and the Undecidable Dreamer

The *Zhuangzi*'s most famous passage, in Giles's translation, ends: "Now I do not know whether I was then a man dreaming I was a butterfly, or whether I am now a butterfly, dreaming I am a man." Zhuangzi names the passage between states *wuhua* (物化), the transformation of things, which Giles rendered as "Metempsychosis." The novel's ontological undecidability descends from this passage. Its Western analogues—Plato's cave, Calderón's *La vida es sueño* (1635), Descartes's dream argument (1641)—differ in a decisive respect. Calderón's Segismundo, imprisoned in a tower by a father who has consulted the stars, and Descartes's meditator both seek a criterion that would end doubt. Zhuangzi dissolves the need for one: both states are phases of transformation.

The novel is suspended between these attitudes. Juliana seeks a criterion and asks the oracle for a verdict; Tagomi, in Portsmouth Square, undergoes a transformation that he neither seeks to verify nor can refuse. The tension is made explicit in a later work of the same lineage. Ursula K. Le Guin took the title of *The Lathe of Heaven* (1971) from Legge's version of the *Zhuangzi*: "To let understanding stop at what cannot be understood is a high attainment. Those who cannot do it will be destroyed on the lathe of Heaven." Le Guin's George Orr, whose dreams rewrite reality, opposes the technocrat Haber, who would engineer worlds for the general good. Le Guin makes explicit the opposition that Dick's novel leaves embedded: between the dreamer who yields and the engineer who wills.

2.3 Chan, Zen, and the Pacific Reception

Dick wrote within a Bay Area saturated by the Anglophone reception of Zen: D. T. Suzuki's essays and his *Zen and Japanese Culture* (1959), Alan Watts's *The Way of Zen* (1957), Kerouac's *The Dharma Bums* (1958), Gary Snyder's residence in Kyoto from 1956. The novel both participates in this reception and inverts it. The Japanese elite of the Pacific States perform toward American objects the connoisseurship that Bay Area Americans were then performing toward Japanese ones.

The reception was itself impure. Brian Victoria's *Zen at War* (1997) documented the support of prominent Zen institutions and teachers for Japanese militarism, and Suzuki's prewar writing had linked Zen to the samurai ethos. The aesthetic of emptiness that Tagomi embodies arrived in California entangled with the ideology of the empire he serves. The novel does not purify it; it tests it.

The form of that test is the koan. The *Wumenguan* (1228), compiled by Wumen Huikai under a title meaning "the gateless gate," opens with Zhaozhou's answer to the question whether a dog has Buddha-nature: *Wu* (無; Japanese *mu*). A koan is an object that resists discursive solution and yields only when effort is abandoned. Chapter 8 will read the silver triangle as Tagomi's koan and his passage into another San Francisco as a passage through the gateless gate.

2.4 The Philology of *Wu*

In the novel, *wu* names a quality an object may possess: an inner balance or rightness that places the thing in accord with the Way. Paul Kasoura discerns it in Frank Frink's jewellery, which is neither antique nor junk. Dick's usage has no exact equivalent in Chinese, and that inexactness is productive. The syllable *wu*, distributed across all four tones of Mandarin, names five forces that organise the novel:

Character	Tone	Sense	Function in the novel
巫 *wū*	1	diviner, spirit-medium	the oracle and its mantic origins
無 *wú*	2	non-being, emptiness	the void at the centre of Hexagram 61; the *mu* of the koan
武 *wǔ*	3	martial, violence	Juliana's judo and razor; Tagomi's Colt
物 *wù*	4	thing, object	the forged and the authentic artefact
悟 *wù*	4	awakening (Japanese *satori*)	Tagomi's vision in Portsmouth Square

The table records a tonal constellation, not an etymology. Its heuristic value is that Dick's single English loan-word condenses the novel's plot: a thing (物) bearing an emptiness (無) precipitates an awakening (悟) that leads to a refusal of violence (武), while the diviner (巫) presides. Japanese aesthetics confirm the conjunction of thing and feeling. Motoori Norinaga's *mono no aware* (物の哀れ), the pathos of things, uses the same character for "thing"; *wabi*, *sabi*, and *yūgen* name the austere, the patinated, and the darkly profound, qualities a collector of Americana might mistake for historicity.

The empty centre returns in the oracle's final verdict. Hexagram 61 places the trigram *Xun* (wind) above *Dui* (lake); its image is wind over the lake (澤上有風). Read from the bottom, its lines run firm, firm, yielding, yielding, firm, firm. The two broken lines enclosed at the centre were read by the commentarial tradition as an empty heart (*zhongxu*, 中虛), free of prejudice and therefore open to truth, while the firm lines at the centre of each trigram signify sincerity's strength. The hexagram of "Inner Truth" thus carries emptiness at its core. The truth the oracle gives Juliana has the same form as the *wu* Kasoura sees in the jewel and as the void at the hub of the *Laozi*'s wheel.

2.5 Synchronicity and Its Discontents

Jung's collaboration with Wilhelm predates the *I Ching* foreword: their *Das Geheimnis der goldenen Blüte* (1929) joined a Daoist alchemical text to Jung's psychological commentary, and

Jung's memorial address for Wilhelm (1930) already framed the *I Ching* as a means of grasping the qualitative character of a moment. Three further Jungian theses shape the novel.

The first is Jung's rejection of evil as privation. Augustine had defined evil as the privation of good (*Enchiridion* 11; *Confessions* VII). Jung attacked the doctrine in *Aion* (1951) and *Answer to Job* (1952), insisting on the reality of evil as a psychic and cosmic power. Tagomi's insistence, after the killings, that evil is an actual ingredient of the world, as substantial and obdurate as cement, is anti-Augustinian in precisely Jung's sense.

The second is the analysis of National Socialism as archetypal possession. In "Wotan" (1936) Jung read the movement as the eruption of a storm god in the German collective psyche. His earlier concept of inflation (1928)—the ego's identification with archetypal contents, producing a sense of godlikeness—anticipates Wegener's diagnosis of the Nazi mind as one that has confused itself with the agency of the cosmos.

The third thesis is synchronicity, and here the discontents begin. From 1933 Jung presided over the International General Medical Society for Psychotherapy and edited its journal, the *Zentralblatt für Psychotherapie*. Its December 1933 issue carried a declaration, drafted by the leader of the society's German section, Matthias Heinrich Göring, a cousin of Hermann Göring, that committed the German section to Hitler's political and ideological principles; Jung later said it had been meant only for a German supplement. His own essay in the journal the following year asserted that the "Aryan" unconscious had a higher potential than the "Jewish." The record is not one-sided: in 1934 Jung also amended the society's statutes so that Jewish physicians excluded from the German section could remain members as individuals. But the oracle's chief Western sponsor lent his authority to a racial psychology while the regime the oracle repudiates was writing race into law (Cocks 1985). The genealogy is again impure.

Synchronicity nevertheless becomes the novel's formal principle. From within the narrative, Frink's jewel, Tagomi's vision, and Frink's release are causally invisible to every agent and appear only as meaningful coincidence. From the reader's vantage, they form a causal chain. Chapter 10 extends this double perspective from events to worlds: what the reader sees as fictional causality, the characters experience as acausal correspondence between worlds.

CHAPTER THREE

The Metaphysics of the Reich: Scale, Boomerang, Technics, and Two Gnosticisms

3

Dick's Nazis are not caricatures. They are rendered in the idiom of their own self-understanding—Consul Reiss's urbane fatigue, Lotze's cosmic condescension, the professional calm of the SD—and the novel's moral force derives from that fidelity. This chapter reconstructs the four theses about National Socialism that the novel dramatises and locates their originators.

3.1 The Archival Descent

Dick prepared the novel by reading in the University of California library at Berkeley, including wartime German documents, alongside the standard histories of the Reich (Shirer 1960; Bullock 1952). In later interviews he recalled a diary entry by an SS man stationed in occupied Poland who complained that the cries of starving children were keeping him awake. Dick cited the entry as the reason he could not return to the Nazi mind to write the sequel he had planned. The anecdote condenses the novel's method: the perpetrator's discomfort is recorded without the perpetrator registering its meaning.

The composition of the novel in 1961 coincided with the trial of Adolf Eichmann in Jerusalem (April–December 1961). Arendt's report, *Eichmann in Jerusalem* (1963), would make the thoughtless functionary the paradigm of modern evil. Dick's Reich already anticipates that paradigm: its genocides are administered, its officials literate and fatigued, its crimes routinised into paperwork such as the extradition order that Tagomi will refuse to sign.

3.2 The Pathology of Scale

Wegener's diagnosis of the Nazi mind is the novel's principal theoretical statement about fascism. In his account the Nazis see from the standpoint of geological time and planetary destiny. They identify their will with the agency of history and are thereby blind to the particular person. Their colonisation of space and their exterminations are products of the same view from above.

The diagnosis converges with Arendt's analysis of ideology in *The Origins of Totalitarianism* (1951; "Ideology and Terror," added in 1958). Arendt described ideology as the logic of an idea emancipated from experience, rendering human beings superfluous. She also identified the ideal subject of totalitarian rule as a person for whom the distinction between fact and fiction no longer holds. That claim illuminates the status of *The Grasshopper Lies Heavy* within the Reich. The book is dangerous not because it lies but because it is an avowed fiction that points toward a fact, and thereby restores the distinction that the regime requires its subjects to lose.

The pathology of scale has a theological counterpoint in Pascal. "Le silence éternel de ces espaces infinis m'effraie"—the eternal silence of these infinite spaces terrifies me (*Pensées*, 1670). Pascal's terror is the posture of a creature who knows its scale. The Reich of the novel has lost that terror; it experiences infinite space as territory. Against it the *Laozi* sets the counsel of chapter 63, to do great things while they are small. The novel's moral victories—a jewel, a signature withheld, a question put to a book—are all small.

3.3 Imperialism's Boomerang: Africa in the Novel

The Reich of 1962 has drained the Mediterranean for agriculture and has all but exterminated the population of Africa. Both details have exact genealogies.

Arendt placed Cecil Rhodes's dictum "I would annex the planets if I could" at the threshold of her account of imperialism, which she read as the antechamber of totalitarianism. The Reich's Mars programme realises Rhodes's fantasy. Aimé Césaire's *Discours sur le colonialisme* (1950) advanced the sharper thesis that Europe tolerated Nazism until it applied to Europeans the procedures hitherto reserved for colonised peoples. Dick's Reich returns those procedures to their point of origin and thereby completes Césaire's circuit.

The history behind the circuit is specific. In German South West Africa the war against the Herero and Nama (1904–1908) is widely regarded as the first genocide of the twentieth century. On 2 October 1904 General Lothar von Trotha, commander of the colonial *Schutztruppe*, proclaimed that every Herero found within the German borders would be shot and that women and children would be driven back or fired upon. His troops drove Herero families into the Omaheke desert and cordoned its edge. Survivors, first Herero and then Nama, were confined in camps the colonial administration itself called *Konzentrationslager*; the deadliest stood on Shark Island at Lüderitz. Commonly cited estimates put the dead at about 65,000 of some 80,000 Herero and about 10,000 of some 20,000 Nama. Skulls of prisoners who died in the camps were shipped to scientists in Germany for racial research. In 2021 the German government formally acknowledged the killings as genocide (Olusoga and Erichsen 2010; Zimmerer 2011).

The colony's first Reichskommissar (1885–1890) was Heinrich Göring, father of Hermann Göring, whom Dick names among the contenders for the chancellorship after Bormann's death. The anthropologist Eugen Fischer conducted his study of the Rehoboth "Basters" there (1913) and later directed the Kaiser Wilhelm Institute for Anthropology, Human Heredity and

Eugenics (1927–1942). Under the Reich the institute prepared expert reports on racial descent, and Fischer's successor, Otmar von Verschuer, received specimens taken from prisoners at Auschwitz by his former assistant Josef Mengele (Schmuhl 2008). Jürgen Zimmerer's continuity thesis, "from Windhoek to Auschwitz" (2011), has been contested (Gerwarth and Malinowski 2009). Dick's novel does not adjudicate the dispute. It dramatises its premise: colonial genocide and continental genocide belong to a single imaginary of racial space.

The drained Mediterranean has a real source in the engineer Herman Sörgel's Atlantropa project, advanced from 1928, which proposed to dam the Strait of Gibraltar, lower the sea, irrigate the Sahara, and fuse Europe and Africa into a single continent. Sörgel conceived it as a pacific alternative to war. Dick's Reich realises it as genocidal agronomy. The image will recur in Chapter 8 as the lake without water of Hexagram 47.

3.4 Reactionary Modernism and the *Gestell*

Jeffrey Herf's *Reactionary Modernism* (1984) described the Nazi synthesis of technological modernity with romantic irrationalism. Dick's Reich is that synthesis in its fulfilled form: rockets to Mars and Venus coexist with the racial mythology of Alfred Rosenberg's *Der Mythus des 20. Jahrhunderts* (1930).

Heidegger supplies the most uncomfortable genealogy. In "Die Frage nach der Technik" (1953, published 1954) he described modern technology as *Gestell*, an enframing that reveals all beings, human beings included, as standing-reserve (*Bestand*). In the Bremen lectures of 1949 he notoriously equated motorised agriculture in its essence with the manufacture of corpses in gas chambers. Dick's Reich unites exactly those terms—Africa transformed into an agricultural reserve by extermination—but with a moral seriousness that Heidegger's analogy conspicuously lacks.

Horkheimer and Adorno's *Dialektik der Aufklärung* (1947) gives the general law: myth is already enlightenment, and enlightenment reverts to mythology, because the domination of external nature culminates in the domination of human nature. Benjamin's epilogue to the artwork essay (1935–36) gives its aesthetic form: fascism aestheticises politics, proclaims *fiat ars, pereat mundus*, and offers a humanity so self-alienated that it can experience its own destruction as aesthetic pleasure of the first order. Lotze's contempt for the earthbound is that pleasure in conversational form.

The history again underwrites the fiction. The V-2 was assembled in the Mittelwerk tunnels by concentration-camp prisoners under SS administration; an estimated 20,000 of them died in the Mittelbau-Dora camp system, more than were killed by the weapon itself. Wernher von Braun, the programme's technical director and a member of the NSDAP from 1937 and of the SS from 1940, then entered the United States under Operation Paperclip and led the development of the Saturn V (Neufeld 1995). The Reich reaches Mars in Dick's fiction. In history, the Reich's engineers reached the Moon under another flag.

3.5 Two Gnosticisms

Eric Voegelin's *The New Science of Politics* (1952) characterised modern totalitarian movements as Gnostic attempts to immanentise the eschaton. He traced the symbol of the Third Reich to Joachim of Fiore's doctrine of three ages, transmitted to the radical right through Arthur Moeller van den Bruck's *Das Dritte Reich* (1923). Hans Jonas, Heidegger's Jewish student, approached the same nexus from the other side: *The Gnostic Religion* (1958) and the essay "Gnosticism and Modern Nihilism" (1952) identified in ancient Gnostic acosmism the structural antecedent of his teacher's existentialism, with its thrownness into an alien world.

Dick's later fiction is avowedly Gnostic. *VALIS* (1981) and the *Exegesis* posit a counterfeit world, a "Black Iron Prison," from which salvation comes by anamnesis, the recollection of a truer reality. Voegelin's analysis therefore poses a problem: the vocabulary Dick used for liberation is the vocabulary Voegelin used for totalitarianism.

The novel of 1962 resolves the problem by distinguishing two Gnosticisms. **Demiurgic gnosis** is the elect's will to seize the creator's role and remake the cosmos by technique; it is Voegelin's Gnosticism, and it is the Reich's. **Anamnestic gnosis** is the recognition that the world is false in order to recall a truer one; it is Dick's, and it is Juliana's. In the Gnostic myths, Sophia descends into a counterfeit world and carries the knowledge of its falsity. Juliana is the novel's proto-Sophia: she travels from the neutral zone to the source of the forbidden book, kills the archon's agent on the way, and returns with the knowledge that the world is not what it claims to be.

CHAPTER FOUR

Counterfactual Lineages: From Livy to the Jonbar Hinge

4

Every prior form of counterfactual thought—historiographic, fictional, and philosophical—relates worlds diachronically, through a shared past and a point of divergence, or comparatively, by degrees of similarity. This chapter traces those forms and identifies the problem none of them solves: how one world could know another without causal contact.

4.1 Classical and Early Modern Counterfactuals

The earliest sustained counterfactual in Western historiography is Livy's digression on what would have happened had Alexander turned west and fought Rome (*Ab Urbe Condita* IX.17–19). Livy concludes that Rome would have prevailed. The counterfactual serves to legitimate the actual, a function it would retain in Leibniz and Hegel. Pascal's aphorism on Cleopatra's nose —"s'il eût été plus court, toute la face de la terre aurait changé"—states the opposing intuition of radical contingency.

The nineteenth century turned the device into a genre. Louis Geoffroy's *Napoléon et la conquête du monde* (1836) narrated a Napoleon who did not retreat from Moscow and went on to universal monarchy. Charles Renouvier coined the word *uchronie* in a work first serialised in 1857 and published as a book in 1876; he intended it as a philosophical instrument for asserting human freedom against Hegelian necessity. G. M. Trevelyan's "If Napoleon Had Won the Battle of Waterloo" (1907) brought the form into English historiography, and J. C. Squire's anthology *If It Had Happened Otherwise* (1931) consolidated it.

Squire's volume contains the most important precedent for *The Grasshopper Lies Heavy*. Winston Churchill's "If Lee Had Not Won the Battle of Gettysburg" (1930) is written by a historian in a world where the Confederacy won, who speculates about a world in which it lost—approximately ours—and imagines it wrongly. It is a double counterfactual: an alternate world imagining an alternate world that resembles, but is not, the reader's. Abendsen's novel has exactly this structure. Dick's Grasshopper world even installs Churchill as its dominant postwar statesman, folding the genre's founding gesture into its most celebrated instance.

4.2 Pulp Speculation and the Hinge

The American magazines of the interwar period gave the counterfactual its vocabulary. Murray Leinster's "Sidewise in Time" (*Astounding*, June 1934) displaced fragments of the Earth into parallel timelines. Jack Williamson's *The Legion of Time* (*Astounding*, 1938) made two futures depend on whether a boy, John Barr, picks up a magnet or a pebble; criticism has since called the minimal decisive event a **Jonbar hinge**. L. Sprague de Camp's *Lest Darkness Fall* (1939) sent a modern archaeologist into Ostrogothic Rome—the world of Boethius—to forestall the Dark Ages. Ward Moore's *Bring the Jubilee* (1953), which Dick acknowledged as an influence, perfected the hinge model: its historian-protagonist travels to Gettysburg and, by an accident, causes the Union victory that annihilates his own Confederate-victory world. The historian becomes the hinge.

Three works prefigure Dick's specific geography. Katharine Burdekin's *Swastika Night* (1937), published as by Murray Constantine, imagines Europe seven centuries after a Nazi victory. Its knight von Hess guards a secret book of true history and a photograph showing Hitler as an ordinary man rather than a blond god. Sarban's *The Sound of His Horn* (1952) depicts the hunting of human beings on a Reich nobleman's estate. C. M. Kornbluth's "Two Dooms" (*Venture*, July 1958) sends a Los Alamos physicist, under a hallucinogen administered by Hopi acquaintances, into a future United States partitioned between the Reich and Imperial Japan; he returns to complete the bomb. It is the most direct precursor of Dick's partitioned America.

All three remain diachronic. Burdekin's book is a relic transmitted from the past; Sarban's frame is a dream-transit; Kornbluth's vision is causally embedded, since it motivates the physicist's action in the real past. In each, the other world is reached by a passage through time.

4.3 Borges and the Fork

Borges's "El jardín de senderos que se bifurcan" (1941) concerns a novel by Ts'ui Pên that is a labyrinth of time, in which every alternative is realised in a branching web of incompatible futures. The story is set during the First World War, and its narrator is a Chinese agent spying for Germany. Its first English translation appeared in *Ellery Queen's Mystery Magazine* in August 1948. The translator was Anthony Boucher, editor of *The Magazine of Fantasy and Science Fiction*, leader of the Berkeley writing circle Dick attended, and the editor who bought Dick's first story, "Roog." No documented influence is claimed here. The genealogical proximity is nonetheless remarkable: the translator of the forking garden was the teacher of the oracle's novelist.

"Tlön, Uqbar, Orbis Tertius" (1940) is the counter-image of the Grasshopper. A fictive world documented in a clandestine encyclopaedia progressively supplants reality. Its postscript, fictively dated 1947, observes that any system with an appearance of order—Borges names dialectical materialism, anti-Semitism, and Nazism—suffices to captivate the minds of men. In

Dick's world, 1947 is the year the Axis war ends. Tlön is an ordered fiction that conquers reality; the Grasshopper is an oracle-generated fiction that unmasks it.

Borges's "La lotería en Babilonia" (1941) imagines a society governed entirely by chance administered by a secret Company: chance as total power, opposed to the oracle's chance as meaningful address. "La biblioteca de Babel" (1941), anticipated by Kurd Lasswitz's "Die Universalbibliothek" (1904), imagines the finite totality of all possible books. The Chinese tradition had already produced its own such library. The *Jiaoshi Yilin*, attributed to the Han scholar Jiao Yanshou, supplies a verse for each of the 4,096 transitions (64 × 64) by which one hexagram becomes another—a complete, finite inventory of possible changes.

4.4 The Philosophical Counterfactual

Leibniz's late fragment on *apokatastasis* (c. 1715) argued from the finitude of possible narratives of bounded length to the eventual recurrence of history, linking combinatorics to the eternal return. Hugh Everett's relative-state formulation of quantum mechanics (1957), published four years before Dick began his novel, made every branch of the universal wave function equally real.

Analytic philosophy formalised the counterfactual a decade later. David Lewis's *Counterfactuals* (1973) held that "if A were the case, C would be the case" is true just in case some world where A and C hold is closer to actuality than any world where A holds without C. Its operative relation is similarity. Lewis's "Truth in Fiction" (1978) analysed what is true in a fiction by reference to the worlds in which the fiction is told as known fact. *On the Plurality of Worlds* (1986) defended modal realism: other worlds exist as concretely as ours, but they are spatiotemporally and causally isolated from it, and we know them only by reasoning, never by observation. Saul Kripke's *Naming and Necessity* (1980; lectures 1970) insisted that possible worlds are stipulated, not discovered through a telescope, and that names designate rigidly. "Hitler" picks out the same man in every world in which he exists, including the world in which he wins.

4.5 The Unsolved Problem

Every model surveyed relates worlds in one of two ways. Either they share a causal past until a hinge (Livy, Geoffroy, Williamson, Moore, Kornbluth, Everett's branching), or they are compared by similarity without any contact at all (Lewis). Only two figures gesture beyond this alternative: Leibniz, whose priest sees other worlds in an oracular dream, and Borges, whose labyrinth makes incompatible times coexist. Neither supplies an account of how an inhabitant of one world could receive *knowledge* of another without causation.

Dick's novel poses exactly that problem and answers it. The oracle is a trans-world epistemic channel that is explicitly acausal. Lewis's modal realism forbids such a channel; Jung's synchronicity permits it. Chapter 10 will argue that the channel works because the oracle speaks of types, not tokens, and that a type can be shared by worlds that share nothing causal.

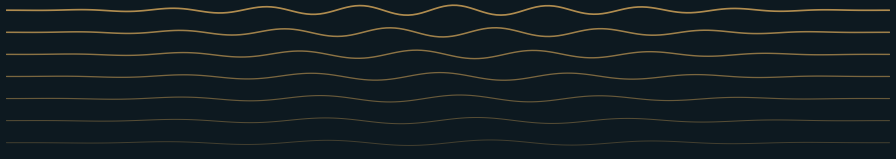
PART TWO



Readings

Hexagram 47 · Kun 困 · Oppression

CHAPTERS 5 – 9



CHAPTER FIVE

Historicity: The Autographic State and the Political Economy of the Forgery

The novel's society is a society of counterfeits. Its antiques are forged, its identities assumed, its regime founded on forged documents. This chapter argues that the forgery is not local colour but the structural secret of the regime of authenticity itself, and it names that regime the **autographic state**.

5.1 Wyndam-Matson's Lighters

The industrialist Wyndam-Matson, whose factory manufactures counterfeit Americana for the Japanese collectors' market, shows his mistress two apparently identical cigarette lighters. One, he says, was in Franklin Roosevelt's pocket on the day of his assassination; the other was not. No physical examination can tell them apart. The difference—what he calls historicity—exists only in the mind and is guaranteed only by a certificate. He offers the demonstration cynically, as proof that the collectors' trade rests on a mental fiction he can manufacture at will. Yet his own argument concedes that the fiction is effective: the certified lighter commands a fortune.

The scene anticipates by two years Arthur Danto's "The Artworld" (1964), which began from perceptually indiscernible objects of which one is an artwork and one is not, and which Danto later systematised in *The Transfiguration of the Commonplace* (1981). It anticipates Nelson Goodman's argument in *Languages of Art* (1968) that a forgery remains aesthetically different from its original even when no difference is presently perceptible, because knowledge of the difference trains future perception. It anticipates Alfred Lessing's counter-argument (1965) that the wrong of forgery is historical and moral rather than aesthetic. Dick reached the problem of indiscernibles from the marketplace rather than the gallery, and he reached it first.

5.2 Autographic and Allographic

Goodman distinguished autographic arts, in which even an exact duplicate does not count as genuine because the history of production is constitutive of the work's identity (painting is the paradigm), from allographic arts, in which a notation fixes identity and any correct instance

counts (music, literature). A painting can be forged; a symphony cannot, though a particular manuscript can.

The dissertation generalises the distinction from artworks to social orders. An **autographic regime** is any order that constitutes the identity and value of persons and things through provenance: through a documented history of production and descent. Walter Benjamin's analysis of the aura (1935–36) describes the aesthetic form of such a regime: "Die Echtheit einer Sache ist der Inbegriff alles vom Ursprung her an ihr Tradierbaren, von ihrer materiellen Dauer bis zu ihrer geschichtlichen Zeugenschaft"—the authenticity of a thing is the quintessence of all that is transmissible in it from its origin, from its material duration to its historical testimony. Benjamin expected mechanical reproduction to dissolve the aura. He also recognised that fascism sought to re-auratise politics in the cult of the leader. The aura was not simply lost; it was weaponised.

5.3 The Autographic State

National Socialism was the most fully realised autographic regime in history. It constituted persons through documentary provenance: the *Ahnenpass*, the ancestral passport, and the *Ariernachweis*, the certificate of Aryan descent. The Nuremberg Laws of 15 September 1935 forbade marriage between "Germans" and "Jews." Lacking any biological test, the First Supplementary Decree to the Reich Citizenship Law (14 November 1935) defined a Jew by the religious affiliation of his or her grandparents. Racial identity was thus determined by parish and synagogue registers. Blood was a document. Within the Reich, these certified classifications decided who would be deported. From October 1941 Jews so defined were sent from Germany to ghettos and killing sites in the occupied East, and across occupied Europe German forces and their auxiliaries murdered some six million Jews by 1945.

The ideological premise of this regime was aesthetic and was articulated long before 1933. Richard Wagner's "Das Judenthum in der Musik" (1850, published under the pseudonym K. Freigedank and reissued under his own name in 1869) cast the Jew as a congenital imitator, incapable of authentic creation and able only to reproduce the forms of a culture to which he could never belong: "Der Jude spricht die Sprache der Nation, unter welcher er von Geschlecht zu Geschlecht lebt, aber er spricht sie immer als Ausländer." The Jew is, in this ideology, the forgery of a German.

Frank Frink, born Fink, is in the regime's terms a forgery: a Jew who has altered the document of his name to pass. The Reich's demand for his extradition is a provenance claim, an assertion that the certificate behind the name overrides the life lived under it. Its consequence is death: handed over to the Reich, Frink would be killed as a Jew. Dick inverts Wagner exactly. The one figure in the novel who makes something authentically new—jewellery that bears *wu*—is the man the regime defines as counterfeit, while the regime that defines authenticity manufactures it from forgeries. The autographic state is parasitic on the counterfeit.

5.4 The Counterfeit Foundations of the Regime of Authenticity

The regime's founding conspiracy text was itself a forgery. The *Protocols of the Elders of Zion*, first published in Russia in 1903, were exposed in 1921 by Philip Graves in *The Times* as a plagiarism of Maurice Joly's satire on Napoleon III, *Dialogue aux enfers entre Machiavel et Montesquieu* (1864). In *Mein Kampf* Hitler answered the exposure by inverting the logic of verification: the persistent insistence of the *Frankfurter Zeitung* that the *Protocols* were forged, he argued, was the best proof of their genuineness. Under the autographic regime the charge of forgery becomes a certificate of authenticity.

The pattern repeats across the regime's history. Between 1942 and 1945, in Operation Bernhard, the SS compelled Jewish and other prisoners at Sachsenhausen to counterfeit British banknotes; the regime that defined Jews as counterfeiters forced Jews to counterfeit for it. Hermann Göring, a connoisseur of plundered old masters, acquired *Christ and the Adulteress* as a Vermeer in exchange for 137 paintings. Its painter, Han van Meegeren, arrested in 1945 for selling Dutch national patrimony to the enemy, proved his innocence of treason by proving his guilt of forgery, painting a new "Vermeer" under supervision; he was convicted of fraud in 1947 and died that December. He became a popular hero for duping the Reichsmarschall, although a copy of his book of drawings (1942), inscribed to Hitler as his "beloved Führer," surfaced after the war; van Meegeren claimed he had only signed it (Lopez 2008). The afterlife continues: in 1983 the "Hitler Diaries" forged by Konrad Kujau were briefly authenticated by Hugh Trevor-Roper, author of *The Last Days of Hitler* (1947).

The genealogy reaches back before the Reich. James Macpherson's Ossian poems (1760–65), presented as translations of an ancient Gaelic bard, were largely his own composition. They nevertheless inspired Herder's essay on Ossian (1773) and with it the Romantic theory of the national folk-soul from which *völkisch* ideology descended. The metaphysics of origin began with a counterfeit origin.

The novel's social world reproduces this structure. Wyndam-Matson's factory forges Colt revolvers and Civil War memorabilia for Japanese collectors, and Frink works there. Every principal identity is assumed: Wegener travels as "Mr. Baynes," General Tedeki as "Mr. Yatabe," the SD assassin as Joe Cinnadella, the Italian truck driver; Frink was Fink. In a society of counterfeits, the only unforged things are the newly made.

5.5 The Antiquarian Colonised: Robert Childan

Robert Childan, proprietor of American Artistic Handcrafts, sells his nation's past to its conquerors. Nietzsche's second *Untimely Meditation* (1874) named this posture antiquarian history: a reverence for the past that preserves it at the cost of mummifying life. Childan's antiquarianism is that of the colonised. His free indirect discourse adopts the clipped, article-dropping English the novel attributes to its Japanese characters; his syntax performs his subjection.

The postcolonial theory of the period describes him with precision. Frantz Fanon's *Peau noire, masques blancs* (1952) analysed the internalisation of the coloniser's gaze; Albert Memmi's *Portrait du colonisé* (1957) described the colonised subject's self-contempt and fantasy of assimilation. Childan exhibits a further structure: his admiration for the Reich and his anti-Semitism amount to a mimicry of the master's master, an identification with the power that stands above his immediate rulers. Homi Bhabha's account of mimicry as a resemblance "almost the same, but not quite" (1984), applied to the Pacific States by Cassie Carter (1995), captures the ambivalence that makes Childan both servile and menacing.

The novel inverts history. In 1942 Executive Order 9066, signed by Roosevelt and enforced by the Army's Western Defense Command under General John L. DeWitt and by the War Relocation Authority, forced some 120,000 people of Japanese ancestry from the West Coast into camps; about two-thirds of them were American citizens. During the occupation of Japan, export goods were stamped "Made in Occupied Japan" (1947–52), and American collectors acquired Japanese objects in quantity. Dick's Japanese collect what America valorised in its own self-image: Colt revolvers, Civil War posters, Mickey Mouse watches, the iconography of frontier violence and mass entertainment. Clement Greenberg's "Avant-Garde and Kitsch" (1939) had already identified kitsch as the official culture of totalitarian regimes. The collectors' fetish reflects back to America the kitsch at the heart of its imperium.

5.6 Childan's Turn

Childan's arc turns when Paul Kasoura, a young Japanese official, examines a piece of Edfrank jewellery and attributes *wu* to it, treating it as a work of art without historicity—authentic because new. Kasoura then relays a business associate's proposal to mass-produce the design as cheap amulets for mass markets. Childan, mortified, insists on an apology.

Three frameworks converge on the scene. Benjamin's reproduction thesis suggests that mass production would destroy the object's aura; but *wu*, unlike aura, is not a function of provenance. Marx's analysis of the commodity suggests that the proposal would convert *wu* into commodity-magic: "A commodity appears, at first sight, a very trivial thing, and easily understood. Its analysis shows that it is, in reality, a very queer thing, abounding in metaphysical subtleties and theological niceties" (*Capital* I, ch. 1 §4, trans. Moore and Aveling). The third framework is the dissertation's own. Childan's demand is the first moment in which he acts not as a colonised subject soliciting the master's recognition but out of fidelity to a value he cannot certify: the worth of a new object without pedigree. The turn is partial. Childan remains calculating and racist, and Dick declines to sanctify him. Fidelity is not purity.

CHAPTER SIX

Monumental, Antiquarian, Critical—and Synchronic: Four Economies of History

6

The novel distributes four relations to the past among its principal groups. Three correspond to Nietzsche's typology of 1874. The fourth, which belongs to the oracle and to those who consult it in good faith, has no place in that typology and is the novel's contribution to the philosophy of history.

6.1 Nietzsche's Typology Extended

In *Vom Nutzen und Nachtheil der Historie für das Leben* (1874), Nietzsche distinguished three uses of history. Monumental history takes past greatness as a model for present action and risks the false analogy that licenses violence. Antiquarian history preserves and reveres the past and risks mummifying life. Critical history drags the past before a tribunal and condemns it in order to free the present, at the risk of severing the roots on which life depends.

Economy	Bearer in the novel	Relation to the past	Characteristic pathology
Monumental	The Reich	The past as model and mandate for planetary destiny	Violence licensed by analogy; the present lived as a future ruin
Antiquarian	Childan and the Japanese collectors	The past as relic, certified by historicity	Mummification; trade in counterfeits
Critical	Abendsen	The past judged and dissolved by a counter-narrative	A new myth of the victors (the Grasshopper's Anglo-American order)
Synchronic	The oracle; Tagomi; Juliana	The present read as an instance of a type shared across worlds	Undecidability; no certificate of any kind

The Reich's monumentalism has a precise architectural correlate. Albert Speer recounted in his *Erinnerungen* (1969) the "theory of ruin value" by which the Reich's monumental buildings were to be designed so as to leave sublime ruins after a millennium. Monumental history, so

conceived, projects the present into the future as its own monument. Dick's Reich of 1962 lives that projection; it experiences its present as already archaeological.

The synchronic economy differs from all three. It neither imitates, preserves, nor judges the past. It asks what configuration the present instantiates, and it treats that configuration as shareable by worlds whose pasts differ.

6.2 Against the Tribunal of World History

Schiller's line "Die Weltgeschichte ist das Weltgericht"—world history is the world's court of judgment—from the poem "Resignation" (1786), was adopted by Hegel in the *Philosophy of Right* (§340). Hegel's lectures on the philosophy of history described their own procedure as "a Theodicæa—a justification of the ways of God" (trans. Sibree), completing in history what Leibniz had attempted in metaphysics. The same lectures concede that "the History of the World is not the theatre of happiness" and that "periods of happiness are blank pages in it."

Hegel's logic, applied to Dick's world, would ratify the Axis: the victor's success would constitute its justification. The novel's most radical gesture is to overrule the tribunal of world history by an oracle that consults no outcome. Its counter-authority is older than Hegel. Augustine asked: "Remota itaque iustitia quid sunt regna nisi magna latrocinia?"—justice removed, what are kingdoms but great bands of robbers? (*De civitate Dei* IV.4). He illustrated the point with the pirate who told Alexander that he was called a robber for doing with one ship what Alexander did with a fleet.

Benjamin's theses "Über den Begriff der Geschichte" (1940) give the modern form of the objection. Historicism, Benjamin argued, empathises with the victor, and its cultural treasures are borne in the victor's triumphal procession: "Es ist niemals ein Dokument der Kultur, ohne zugleich ein solches der Barbarei zu sein." There is no document of culture that is not at the same time a document of barbarism. *The Grasshopper Lies Heavy* is a Benjaminian counter-document. It is written in the victors' world from the standpoint of a victory the defeated did not win.

6.3 Futures Past, Non-Synchronism, and the Incompossible

Reinhart Koselleck's *Vergangene Zukunft* (1979) analysed historical time through the tension between a "space of experience" and a "horizon of expectation." Alternate history is the archive of what Koselleck called futures past: the expectations of earlier presents that did not come to pass. The Grasshopper preserves the futures past of the defeated Allies inside the Axis present.

Ernst Bloch's *Erbschaft dieser Zeit* (1935) supplies the decisive political concept. Bloch explained the success of National Socialism through the *Gleichzeitigkeit des Ungleichzeitigen*, the simultaneity of the non-simultaneous: the coexistence within one present of social strata living in different historical times, whose archaic resentments fascism mobilised alongside modern technics. The novel is saturated with non-synchronism. Its Reich joins racial myth to rocketry;

Japanese functionaries consult a Zhou divination manual in modern offices; Childan sells the nineteenth century to the twentieth; Tagomi glimpses a 1959 freeway as alien futurity.

The synchronic counterfactual raises Bloch's concept from the level of social time to the level of worlds. The simultaneity of the non-simultaneous becomes the co-presence of the incompossible, to use Leibniz's term for worlds that cannot coexist. Gilles Deleuze, in *Cinéma 2: L'image-temps* (1985), read Borges's garden as the thesis that incompossible presents can be simultaneous. He made that thesis the basis of what he called the powers of the false, which replace the form of the true, and he took the forger as their emblematic figure, with Orson Welles's *F for Fake* (1973) as exemplary text.

Deleuze is the dissertation's nearest theoretical neighbour, and the point of divergence must be stated precisely. Nietzsche had already announced the logic Deleuze extends: "Die wahre Welt haben wir abgeschafft: welche Welt blieb übrig? die scheinbare vielleicht? ... Aber nein! mit der wahren Welt haben wir auch die scheinbare abgeschafft!" (*Götzen-Dämmerung*, 1888). Dick's novel stages that double abolition. When the "true" world appears in Tagomi's vision, it is no more true, and no less ugly, than the apparent one. Yet the novel does not conclude, with Deleuze, that the false has replaced the true. It displaces truth from origin and from fact to fidelity. Dick occupies a third position between the metaphysics of origin and the powers of the false.

6.4 Emplotment and the Oracle

Hayden White's *Metahistory* (1973) argued that historiography is constituted by emplotment—romance, tragedy, comedy, satire—and by the master tropes of metaphor, metonymy, synecdoche, and irony. His earlier essay "The Burden of History" (1966) asked historians to liberate the present from the weight of a past that disables action. The novel's inner title names the same weight: the grasshopper lies heavy.

The *I Ching* functions in the novel as an emplotment engine. Its sixty-four situation-types are plot-types, and its changing lines are peripeteias. Dick reported that he consulted the oracle for his characters at their decision points while composing the novel. The book is therefore, in part, oracle-emplotted—a novel partly written by the oracle about a novel wholly written by it.

The method has contemporaries. The Oulipo was founded in November 1960, and Raymond Queneau's *Cent mille milliards de poèmes* (1961), a sonnet machine yielding 10^{14} poems, appeared while Dick was writing. A decade later Italo Calvino's *Il castello dei destini incrociati* (1969; expanded 1973) set mute travellers in a castle, recounting their destinies by laying out tarot cards. Dick's high castle and Calvino's are the two great literary houses of combinatorial divination. In Calvino the cards generate stories; in Dick the coins generate a world that judges the world in which they are cast.

CHAPTER SEVEN

The Grasshopper Lies Heavy: Nested Worlds, Inner Books, and the High Castle

THE INNER NOVEL's facts match no world, including the reader's. This is the exegetical crux most readings either overlook or absorb into metafictional irony. This chapter establishes the crux, situates the inner book among its literary kin, and reads the onomastics of its author and his castle.

7.1 Ecclesiastes 12:5

The inner title comes from Qoheleth's allegory of old age and death. In the Authorized Version: "Also when they shall be afraid of that which is high, and fears shall be in the way, and the almond tree shall flourish, and the grasshopper shall be a burden, and desire shall fail: because man goeth to his long home, and the mourners go about the streets." The verse names not only the inner book but the governing image of the outer one. "That which is high"—the dread of height—and "the grasshopper shall be a burden" stand in a single sentence. The two titles of Dick's novel are co-present in one verse: the High Castle and the Grasshopper, the dread of the elevated and the weight of the small.

Qoheleth's keyword, *hevel*—vapour, breath, rendered "vanity" in the Authorized Version—undermines every monumental history. Its sceptical counsel made Ecclesiastes the scripture of the totalitarian imagination's dissidents. In Ray Bradbury's *Fahrenheit 451* (1953), Montag ends the novel as a living custodian of Ecclesiastes among the book-people. Two novels of the period, one American and one Californian, entrusted the survival of truth under tyranny to the book that declares all historical achievement breath.

A second verse sets the problem of Chapter 5: "there is no new thing under the sun" (Ecclesiastes 1:9). Paul Kasoura's attribution of *wu* to a new object—authentic because new—contradicts Qoheleth. The novel stages that contradiction without resolving it.

7.2 The World of the Grasshopper Is Not Ours

In the reader's history, Giuseppe Zangara fired at President-elect Roosevelt in Miami on 15 February 1933, missed, and mortally wounded Chicago's mayor, Anton Cermak, who died on 6 March. In Dick's Axis world (W1), Zangara's shot kills Roosevelt; the presidency passes to John Nance Garner and then to the isolationist John W. Bricker, and an unprepared America loses the war. Both worlds are purchased by a corpse. The reader's world exchanged Roosevelt's survival for Cermak's death.

In Abendsen's world (W2), Roosevelt survives the attempt but leaves office after two terms. His successor, Rexford Tugwell, moves the Pacific Fleet out of Pearl Harbor before the Japanese attack. Italy changes sides—as it did, in fact, in 1943—which provokes Joe Cinnadella's resentment. The Allies win. In the postwar order Churchill's Britain outlasts the United States, the two powers conduct a cold war, and America floods Chiang Kai-shek's China with consumer goods. For a reader of 1962, this last image satirises Henry Luce's "The American Century" (*Life*, February 1941), the doctrine of benevolent hegemony through prosperity.

W2 is a liberal-imperial utopia, and it is not W0. Its facts are wrong about the reader's world at every turn. If the oracle's "Inner Truth" meant correspondence to the facts of the reader's world, the oracle would be false. Since the novel gives no reason to discount the oracle, its truth must be of another kind. Chapter 10 identifies that kind as truth of type.

7.3 Inner Books: A Comparative Typology

The novel-within-the-novel has a distinguished lineage. Each instance locates the authority of the inner book in a different source.

Inner book	Host work	Source of authority	Relation to truth
Shakespeare's works	Huxley, *Brave New World* (1932)	Tradition	The old book as moral standard against the new order
Von Hess's history	Burdekin, *Swastika Night* (1937)	Archive	Truth as a relic preserved against myth
Tlön's encyclopaedia	Borges, "Tlön, Uqbar, Orbis Tertius" (1940)	Order	A fiction that conquers reality by its symmetry
Ts'ui Pên's novel	Borges, "The Garden of Forking Paths" (1941)	Totality	Every outcome realised; truth as the labyrinth itself
Goldstein's book	Orwell, *Nineteen Eighty-Four* (1949)	Power	Revealed as co-written by the Party; truth as trap

Inner book	Host work	Source of authority	Relation to truth
Shade's poem and Kinbote's commentary	Nabokov, *Pale Fire* (1962)	Projection	The inner text as screen for a fantasy kingdom
The Grasshopper Lies Heavy	Dick (1962)	Oracle	False in fact, true in type
Terra	Nabokov, *Ada or Ardor* (1969)	Madness and art	The rumoured other world as a figure of the real
Dick's novel itself	Amis, *The Alteration* (1976)	Contraband	A "Counterfeit World" fiction read in a Catholic-hegemonic world

Two entries require comment. *Pale Fire* was published by G. P. Putnam's Sons in 1962, the house and year of *The Man in the High Castle*; within one publisher's list, two novels-within-novels opened that year onto fantasy kingdoms, one a Zembla of the heart and one an America that never was. Kingsley Amis's *The Alteration*, set in a world in which the Reformation never occurred, includes Dick's novel among the banned "Counterfeit World" fictions read by its schoolboys. The circuit of mutual counterfactual reference closes: an alternate world reads Dick's alternate world as an alternate world.

The Grasshopper differs from every other entry. Its authority is neither tradition, archive, order, totality, power, nor projection, but chance made meaningful. And it is avowedly wrong in its facts yet declared true. André Gide named the device of the embedded work *mise en abyme* in his journal of 1893, after the heraldic figure of a shield bearing a smaller copy of itself. Lucien Dällenbach's *Le Récit spéculaire* (1977) classified its simple, infinite, and aporetic forms. Dick's case fits none of them. The embedded work does not mirror the embedding work; it mirrors a third world. The result may be called an **aspecular mise en abyme**: a mirror that shows not the room in which it hangs but another room.

7.4 Hawthorne Abendsen

The author's forename invokes Nathaniel Hawthorne, whose preface to *The Scarlet Letter*, "The Custom-House" (1850), presents the novel as an elaboration of a manuscript found among the papers of a predecessor, Surveyor Pue. Authorship is disavowed into discovery, as Abendsen disavows his into the oracle. The same preface gives the classic definition of romance as "a neutral territory, somewhere between the real world and fairy-land, where the Actual and the Imaginary may meet, and each imbue itself with the nature of the other." No better definition of the synchronic counterfactual exists. Hawthorne's next preface, to *The House of the Seven Gables* (1851), announced the moral that "the wrong-doing of one generation lives into the successive ones"—the thesis of Chapter 12.

The surname contains *Abend*, evening, and evokes *Abendland*, the Occident. Oswald Spengler's *Der Untergang des Abendlandes* (1918–22) read civilisations as organisms with a destined morphology of youth, maturity, and decline. Spengler shaped the conservative revolution, though his *Jahre der Entscheidung* (1933) displeased the new regime. Abendsen is the son of the evening-land, the West's late child, writing its twilight inverted.

The disavowal of authorship belongs to an older tradition. Cervantes attributed *Don Quixote* to the Moorish historian Cide Hamete Benengeli. Horace Walpole presented *The Castle of Otranto* (1764) as a translation of an Italian manuscript of 1529 before admitting authorship in the second edition. The first Gothic novel was thus a pseudo-translation set in a castle. Macpherson's Ossian, discussed in Chapter 5, completes the series: the found manuscript can be a forgery, a fiction, or an oracle, and the reader cannot tell which by inspecting the text.

7.5 The Castle That Is Not There

Kafka's *Das Schloss* (1926) is the canonical modern castle of authority. Its land surveyor K. never gains access to the officials whose decisions govern the village. Dick reverses Kafka. Juliana reaches the castle, and the castle does not exist. Its legend of electrified wire and fortification dissolves into an ordinary house and a handful of coins.

The German word for a stronghold, *Hochburg*—literally a high castle—is also the standard political term for a party's electoral bastion. Luther's hymn "Ein feste Burg ist unser Gott" made the fortress an image of God. Dick's castle-God is absent, and its absence is the revelation. The German edition of the novel, titled *Das Orakel vom Berge*, relocated authority from fortification to speech, from the castle to the oracle. Ecclesiastes 12:5 completes the figure: those who are "afraid of that which is high" fear the castle. Juliana is the character who stops being afraid of it and finds that height is empty.

CHAPTER EIGHT

Satori in Portsmouth Square: Tagomi and the Phenomenology of the Other World

8

Nobusuke Tagomi, head of the Japanese Trade Mission in San Francisco, is the novel's moral centre. His arc runs from killing, through exhaustion and a vision of the reader's world, to a refusal that saves a man he has never met. This chapter reads that arc as the novel's demonstration that the other world acts upon this one only through a person's transformation.

8.1 The Killing and the Lake Without Water

When SD agents force their way into the Trade Mission to kill Wegener and General Tedeki, Tagomi shoots two of them with a Colt revolver from his collection of Americana. He is a Buddhist, and the first of the five precepts is abstention from taking life (Pali *pāṇātipātā veramaṇī*). The act breaks him.

The weapon carries the novel's argument about historicity. As a collector's object, its value turns entirely on provenance; as a weapon, its function is wholly indifferent to provenance. Authentic or forged, the Colt kills. The autographic regime's distinction between genuine and counterfeit dissolves at the point where objects act upon bodies.

In the aftermath the oracle returns to Tagomi Hexagram 47, *Kun* (困), "Oppression" or "Exhaustion." Its trigrams place *Dui* (lake) above *Kan* (water), and its image is a lake whose water has drained away beneath it. The figure is personal and cosmic at once. It names the moral exhaustion of the killer and, at the scale of the Reich, the drained Mediterranean of Sörgel's Atlantropa made genocidal fact.

Set beside Hexagram 61, the image discloses a structural rhyme. Both hexagrams contain the lake trigram. In 47 the lake stands above water that has drained out of it; in 61 the lake lies beneath a wind that stirs its surface. The novel's movement from Tagomi's exhaustion to Juliana's verdict is a movement of the same lake from drained to stirred: from the engineered void of the Reich to the receptive void of inner truth.

8.2 The Triangle and the Vision

Tagomi attempts to rid himself of the Colt by trading it back to Childan, and Childan instead persuades him to buy a small silver triangle from the Edfrank workshop. In Portsmouth Square, Tagomi contemplates the object. At first he interrogates it, demanding that it yield its meaning; the effort fails. When he relinquishes it, he finds himself in another San Francisco. The city is dominated by the Embarcadero Freeway, which Tagomi experiences as a monstrous structure. There are no pedicabs, and white men treat him with indifference or contempt; a lunch counter refuses him the deference his rank commands at home. He is shaken, and he returns.

Three phenomenological frameworks illuminate the passage. Heidegger's analysis of equipment in *Sein und Zeit* (1927, §16) shows that a broken tool becomes conspicuous and thereby discloses the referential totality of the world in which it functioned. Tagomi is himself the broken tool; his breakdown discloses not his own world but another. Husserl's epoché (*Ideen I*, 1913) suspends the natural attitude in order to make the world appear as world; Tagomi's suspension is involuntary and opens onto a different world entirely. The Zen tradition supplies the third framework. The triangle functions as a koan, which yields only when discursive effort is abandoned, and Tagomi's passage is a passage through the gateless gate of the *Wumenguan*.

The content of the vision is the decisive datum, and it is anti-utopian. The double-decked Embarcadero Freeway was completed in 1959 and became the target of the San Francisco "freeway revolt" that halted further construction; it was demolished after the Loma Prieta earthquake of 1989. Tagomi sees the reader's world—Allied, victorious, real—and finds it ugly. Its racial contempt is the afterlife of the mass incarceration of Japanese Americans that began in 1942. The "true" world into which the satori opens is not paradise. Whatever the oracle will mean by Inner Truth, it cannot mean that the reader's world is good.

8.3 *Gelassenheit* and the Word That Did Not Come

Tagomi's releasement has an uncomfortable European counterpart. In the summer of 1946, during his denazification proceedings, Heidegger worked with the Chinese scholar Paul Shih-yi Hsiao on a translation of chapters of the *Laozi*. His *Gelassenheit* (1959), published two years before Dick wrote the novel, made releasement toward things and openness to the mystery the posture of post-metaphysical thinking. Reinhard May's *Ex oriente lux* (1989; English 1996) argued that East Asian sources shaped Heidegger's later work more than he acknowledged.

The comparison clarifies Tagomi's achievement by contrast. Heidegger's releasement issued in silence about the crimes of the regime he had served. When Paul Celan visited him at Todtnauberg in July 1967, the poem Celan wrote afterward records a hope for a word from the thinker that did not come. Tagomi's releasement issues in a word, and the word is "no."

8.4 The Refusal

Returned to the Trade Mission, Tagomi receives the Reich's consul, Freiherr Hugo Reiss, who presents the papers for the transfer to German custody of a Jew held by the San Francisco police: Frank Frink, whom the transfer would deliver to his death. Tagomi refuses to sign and orders Frink's release.

The scene inverts a scriptural archetype. "When Pilate saw that he could prevail nothing, but that rather a tumult was made, he took water, and washed his hands before the multitude, saying, I am innocent of the blood of this just person: see ye to it" (Matthew 27:24, Authorized Version). The extradition form invites the administrative handwashing of *see ye to it*; Tagomi declines it. He is the anti-Eichmann, the functionary who does not sign. Arendt's account of the desk murderer, published the year after the novel, finds in Tagomi its fictional refutation.

History supplies an exact Japanese analogue. In July and August 1940 Chiune Sugihara, Japanese vice-consul in Kaunas, issued transit visas to thousands of Jewish refugees against his government's instructions; Yad Vashem recognised him as Righteous Among the Nations in 1985. Sugihara saved lives by signing; Tagomi saves a life by refusing to sign. The gestures are opposite and the fidelity identical. Fidelity attaches not to a form of action but to the inner truth the action serves.

8.5 The Acausal Chain

The sequence that saves Frink is the novel's most rigorous construction. Frink makes the triangle. Childan reluctantly takes it into stock and sells it to Tagomi. The triangle precipitates Tagomi's vision. The vision precipitates his refusal. The refusal frees Frink, who never learns why and returns to his workbench. Frink's own creation saves his life through a mind he will never meet.

From within the narrative, the chain is invisible to every agent: Tagomi does not know who made the triangle, Frink does not know who released him, Childan does not know what he sold. Each link appears, to those inside it, as meaningful coincidence. From the reader's vantage, it is a causal sequence. Leibniz had explained the coordination of windowless monads by a harmony pre-established by God. Dick secularises that doctrine into what may be called **synchronic grace**: a providence without a provider, in which the good one makes returns through channels no agent can see. The chain is the novel's demonstration, at the scale of a single life, of the structure Chapter 10 attributes to the relation between worlds.

CHAPTER NINE

Juliana: Judith, Sophia, and the Hermeneutics of the Empty Castle

Juliana Frink is the novel's reader. She reads the forbidden book, interprets the man who claims to admire it, travels to its source, and puts to the oracle the question that ends the novel. This chapter argues that her journey enacts a hermeneutics in which interpretation culminates not in a meaning but in an act, and in which the authority sought at the end of the journey turns out to be empty.

9.1 The Gentle Way

Juliana teaches judo in Canon City, Colorado, in the neutral Rocky Mountain States. Kanō Jigorō founded the Kōdōkan in 1882 on the principle of *jū* (柔), yielding: the weaker combatant overcomes the stronger by receiving and redirecting force rather than opposing it. Kanō later condensed the art into two maxims, *seiryoku zen'yō* (maximum efficient use of energy) and *jita kyōei* (mutual welfare and benefit). The principle is the *Laozi*'s water in the body: nothing is softer, yet nothing surpasses it against the hard.

Juliana's relation to the occupier's culture is thus the obverse of Childan's. Childan sells his own nation's past to its conquerors and mimics their speech. Juliana has mastered the conquerors' art and teaches it to Americans. Hers is appropriation without servility, a mimicry that empowers rather than abases.

9.2 Joe Cinnadella and the Razor

Joe Cinnadella presents himself as an Italian truck driver and a veteran of the Italian army. He is in fact an SD assassin sent to kill Abendsen. He resents Italy's subordinate place in the Axis, and he takes the Grasshopper's depiction of Italy changing sides—the reader's history of 1943—as a personal insult. He combines erotic magnetism, cultural pretension, and fascist allegiance, and Juliana is drawn to him.

The seduction is the novel's analysis of fascism's attraction. Susan Sontag's "Fascinating Fascism" (1975), on the aesthetics of Leni Riefenstahl, would describe the erotic pull of a politics of

virility, discipline, and submission. Borges's "Tlön" had diagnosed the related appeal of any symmetrical order. Joe offers Juliana both: his body and his certainty.

In a Denver hotel, having understood his purpose, Juliana opens Joe's throat with a razor blade. The act has an ancient typology. Judith, a widow, enters the tent of Holofernes, the general of the empire besieging her people, and kills him with his own sword: "And she smote twice upon his neck with all her might, and she took away his head from him" (Judith 13:8, Authorized Version). Jael kills Sisera with a tent peg (Judges 4:21). Artemisia Gentileschi's paintings of Judith (c. 1612–13 and c. 1620) made the scene an icon of female agency against male violence. Juliana is a divorcée rather than a widow, but she is the former wife of a Jew, and she kills the agent of an empire to save the author whose book sustains the occupied.

The Confucian tradition supplies a parallel justification. Asked whether a minister may kill his sovereign, Mencius answered, in Legge's translation: "I have heard of the cutting off of the fellow Châu, but I have not heard of the putting a sovereign to death, in his case" (*Mencius* I.ii. 8). The tyrant who outrages benevolence and righteousness forfeits his rank and becomes a mere fellow.

Dick nonetheless withholds the comfort of typology. Juliana's act is unplanned and eruptive; afterward she is disoriented and near collapse. It is neither heroism nor crime in any settled sense. It is the eruption of the martial *wu* (武) in a character who had taught violence as a discipline of yielding.

9.3 The Journey to the Castle

Juliana's journey from Denver to Cheyenne has two literary successors and one predecessor. Kafka's K. never reaches the Castle. Thomas Pynchon's Oedipa Maas, in *The Crying of Lot 49* (1966), is a Californian woman who decodes the signs of a possible conspiracy, the Tristero, without ever learning whether her revelation is real or paranoid; the novel ends as she awaits the auction that may resolve it. Juliana resembles Oedipa in uncertainty but differs in outcome. She arrives, and her uncertainty issues in a question rather than in waiting.

What she finds at the end of the journey is an ordinary house. Abendsen's wife, Caroline, explains that they left the fortified residence of legend. The castle of authority has been abandoned by its own author.

9.4 The Death of the Author and the Birth of the Querent

Abendsen admits that he wrote the book by consulting the oracle at each narrative juncture. Barthes's "The Death of the Author" (1967) is here literalised: the author is replaced by a scriptor who transcribes what is given. Yet Barthes's sequel, the birth of the reader, takes in Dick an unexpected form. Juliana does not merely receive the text; she interrogates its principle of composition. She is the birth of the querent.

Foucault's "Qu'est-ce qu'un auteur?" (1969) distinguished the empirical writer from the author-function that organises a discourse and makes it attributable. The Reich's assassin targets the author-function: kill Abendsen, and the book loses its name. But the book's real author cannot be assassinated. The oracle has no body.

Juliana's question returns Hexagram 61. Its image, wind over lake, names the only mode in which the other world can appear in this one. Wind is invisible; it becomes visible only in its effect upon the surface of water. The Grasshopper's world is likewise visible only in its effects—on Juliana, on Tagomi, on the readers of the Pacific States. The hexagram's empty centre, two yielding lines enclosed by firm ones, is the formal image of the empty castle. The centre of authority is void, and truth enters through the void, as the *Laozi*'s vessel is useful by its hollowness.

The responses to the verdict are telling. Abendsen, who wanted to write a novel, is disturbed to be told that he has written a truth. Caroline is uneasy. Juliana is exultant, and she leaves.

9.5 Juliana as Sophia

Dick's later mythology, developed in *VALIS* and *The Divine Invasion* (both 1981), centres on Sophia, the divine Wisdom who enters a counterfeit world to awaken those imprisoned in it. Juliana prefigures the figure. She descends from the neutral zone into the Reich's sphere, kills the archon's agent, reaches the source of the forbidden knowledge, and departs with the knowledge that the world is false. Biographers have connected Dick's recurrent dark-haired woman to his twin sister, Jane, who died in infancy in January 1929. Juliana belongs to that series.

The figure of the woman as conduit of revelation carries an old danger. The Pythia at Delphi and the Sibyl at Cumae voiced divine speech without authoring it, and literary tradition has often reduced women to vessels of meaning. Juliana exceeds the type in two respects. She acts, and her act is the novel's most decisive. And she asks: she is the querent, not the medium. At Delphi a woman spoke the oracle to men who asked. In Cheyenne a woman asks the oracle, and the man who transcribed it is the one who cannot bear the answer.

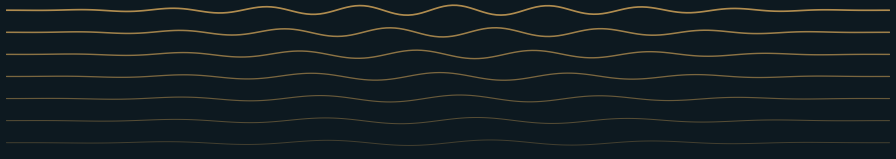
PART THREE



Theory

Hexagram 61 · Zhongfu 中孚 · Inner Truth

CHAPTERS 10–12



CHAPTER TEN

The Synchronic Counterfactual

The novel's central crux—how a book whose facts match no world can be declared true—dissolves once the oracle is understood to speak of types rather than tokens. This chapter defines the synchronic counterfactual, formalises its type–token logic, situates it against modal realism and the powers of the false, and traces its consequences for the genre.

10.1 Two Forms of the Counterfactual

The **diachronic counterfactual** relates an actual world and an alternative that share a history up to a point of divergence, after which they separate causally. Its intelligibility depends on the reader's knowledge of the actual world, which serves as a realist anchor; its poetics is extrapolative plausibility; its epistemic relation is comparison by similarity. The **synchronic counterfactual** relates worlds co-present in the narrative's present. They are connected not only by a shared past but by acausal correspondences that deliver to the inhabitants of one world the type of another. Its poetics is revelation rather than extrapolation, and its epistemic relation is the recognition of type rather than the comparison of tokens.

Dimension	Diachronic counterfactual	Synchronic counterfactual
Relation between worlds	Shared past, causal divergence at a hinge	Co-presence in a shared present
Point of contact	The hinge event (Zangara's shot)	Acausal correspondences: oracle, book, artefact, vision
Epistemic access	Reasoning from the reader's knowledge of the actual	Recognition of a type by those inside the world
Criterion of truth	Plausibility of extrapolation; similarity	Fidelity of token to type (*zhongfu*)
Privileged world	The reader's, as anchor	None; the reader's world is one token among others
Paradigm texts	Moore, *Bring the Jubilee*; Harris, *Fatherland*	Dick, *The Man in the High Castle*

Dick's novel contains both forms. Zangara's successful shot is a classic hinge, and the novel's alternative geography is extrapolated from it. But the hinge is mentioned and passed over; the plot is driven by the synchronic correspondences. The temporal setting confirms the subordination. The novel is set in 1962, the year of its publication. Its alternative world is not a past the reader might have had but a present the reader might be having.

10.2 Hexagrams as Transworld Types

Chapter 1 established that a hexagram names a time: a configuration of forces abstracted from particulars, instantiable in indefinitely many concrete moments. The Han tradition's third sense of *Yi*, non-change (*buyi*), names the invariance of the type across the variation of its tokens. Such a configuration is not confined to one world. Any world containing a moment of that shape instantiates it. The hexagram is therefore a **transworld type**, and the oracle's answers are world-invariant: what it says of the type of the present is true wherever that type obtains.

The structure can be stated schematically. Let W be a set of worlds, each with its moments; let T be the set of sixty-four situation-types; let τ assign to each moment m, in whatever world, the type it instantiates. The ideal oracle O returns the type of the moment of consultation, with no causal link between the fall of the coins and the type returned. The correspondence is synchronistic in Jung's sense.

$$O(m) = \tau(m) \qquad \text{for any moment } m \text{ in any world } w \in W$$

Two notions of truth then separate. A text is **token-true** at a world when its propositions match that world's facts. A text is **type-true** when the configuration it expresses matches the type of the moment it addresses.

$$\text{True}_{\text{type}}(G, m) \;\Leftrightarrow\; \tau_G = \tau(m)$$

The Grasshopper Lies Heavy is token-false in the Axis world, where the Axis won, and token-false in the reader's world, where Tugwell never held office and Britain did not outlast America. Juliana's question asks for the type of the book's production. The answer, *zhongfu*, says that the book is a faithful expression of the type of the present. That present's type is the one the *Laozi* calls reversal: an order at its maximal yang, already exhausted, already turning. "Germany and Japan lost" is true at the level of type even where the token history records their victory.

The inference has a further consequence, which links the theory to Chapter 5. The Axis victory, so read, is a token without the type that would make it real. In the vocabulary of the forger, it is a counterfeit: an object bearing every outward mark of the genuine article without its backing. Inner Truth discloses the forgery. Chapter 11 develops the ontology implied.

10.3 Synchronistic Modal Realism

David Lewis's modal realism holds that other worlds are as real as ours but causally isolated, known only by reasoning. Jung's synchronicity holds that meaningful correlation can obtain without causation. The novel's cosmology combines the two. Its worlds are causally isolated, as Lewis requires: no traveller passes between them, no signal crosses. They are nonetheless correlated in meaning, as Jung allows, because they instantiate shared types. The position may be called **synchronistic modal realism**.

Leibniz anticipated its structure without its conclusion. His monads have no windows, yet their states correspond by pre-established harmony. Dick's oracle is not a window in the monad but an index of the harmony: it does not look into another world; it names the type that this world shares with others. Kripke's objection to possible-worlds talk—that worlds are stipulated, not discovered through a telescope—therefore does not touch the novel. The oracle is no telescope. It observes nothing beyond the present moment. It classifies that moment, and the classification is valid wherever the class has members.

The position also clarifies what the novel does not claim. It does not claim that the reader's world is the real one and the Axis world a fiction. Both are tokens. Each is real to the degree that its tokens are backed by their types. That is a claim about fidelity, not about existence.

10.4 The Third Position

Chapter 6 placed Dick between the metaphysics of origin and Deleuze's powers of the false. The type–token analysis states the position exactly. The metaphysics of origin locates truth in provenance: the genuine token is the one with the right history. The powers of the false dissolve truth into the forger's productive capacity: every token is a creation, none is genuine. Dick's position locates truth in the relation between a token and its type. A token with no right history can be true, as Frink's jewellery is. A token with an impeccable history can be false, as the Reich's victory is. Truth is neither descent nor invention. It is fidelity.

10.5 The Genre After Dick

The distinction yields a typology of later alternate history. Robert Harris's *Fatherland* (1992) is a diachronic counterfactual whose plot obeys the logic of provenance: a detective in a victorious Reich authenticates the documents that prove the Holocaust. Philip Roth's *The Plot Against America* (2004) joins the diachronic counterfactual to memoir, anchoring the alternative in the testimony of a remembering child. Michael Chabon's *The Yiddish Policemen's Union* (2007) builds an elaborate hinge-world around a Jewish settlement in Sitka. Christopher Priest's *The Separation* (2002) approaches the synchronic form: twin brothers inhabit histories of the Second World War that coexist without resolution.

Kim Stanley Robinson—who wrote his doctoral dissertation on Dick's novels (published 1984)—produced the most explicit later instance of type-truth. *The Years of Rice and Salt* (2002) imagines a world in which the Black Death destroyed Europe. A group of souls reincarnates across seven centuries, and each new life bears a name beginning with the same initial: K, B, or I. Identity persists as type across tokens that share no body, no memory, and often no culture. Robinson makes visible the logic Dick's oracle implies.

10.6 The End of the Reader's Privilege

The diachronic counterfactual always privileges the reader's world as anchor. The synchronic counterfactual abolishes that privilege. If the oracle speaks of types, its verdict is no more a certificate for the reader's world than for the Axis world. Both are tokens; both may fail their type. Tagomi's vision has already shown that the reader's world is ugly. Chapter 12 will show that it carries the Axis within it.

CHAPTER ELEVEN

Fiduciary Ontology and the Ethics of Fidelity Without Provenance

The oracle's verdict asserts that a world can possess every fact of its existence and every certificate of its legitimacy and still be false. This chapter names the ontology that makes the assertion coherent—**fiduciary ontology**—and derives from it the novel's ethics. Its claim is that worlds hold reality as fiduciary money holds value: neither by substance nor by stamp, but by backing in trust.

11.1 *Fides*, *Fiducia*, *Fu*: A Lexicon of Trust

The Latin lexicon of trust binds speech to deed. Cicero made good faith the foundation of justice: "Fundamentum autem est iustitiae fides, id est dictorum conventorumque constantia et veritas"—the constancy and truthfulness of what is said and agreed (*De officiis* I.23). Emulating the Stoics' zeal for etymology, he derived *fides* from *fiat quod dictum est*: trust is so called because what is said is done. The derivation joins two words this dissertation has kept apart. Fascism's *fiat ars, pereat mundus* (Chapter 3) is a fiat of will; Cicero's *fides* is a fiat of fidelity, the word made good in the deed. Roman law gave the concept juridical form in *fiducia*, the conveyance of property in trust, whence the modern fiduciary; *credere*, to believe, gave the modern world credit.

Roman religion located fidelity in the body. Livy reports that Numa instituted a solemn rite to Fides alone, at which the flamens sacrificed with the hand wrapped to the fingers, signifying "fidem tutandam sedemque eius etiam in dexteris sacratam esse"—that good faith must be guarded and that its seat is consecrated even in the right hand (*Ab Urbe Condita* I.21.4). The right hand is the hand that swears, that clasps in contract, and that signs. Tagomi will keep faith by refusing to use it.

The Chinese graph at the centre of Hexagram 61 is denser still. Xu Shen's *Shuowen jiezi* (c. 100 CE) analyses 孚 *fu* as a claw (爪) above a child (子) and glosses it first as the hatching of eggs, then, secondarily, as trustworthiness (信). Later commentators explained the connection: a brooding bird's eggs hatch at their appointed time without fail, so that incubation became the image of reliability. Twentieth-century philology uncovered a third and darker sense. In Western Zhou bronze inscriptions the same graph records captives taken in war, and Gao Heng (1947)

proposed that in many lines of the *Zhou Yi*'s oldest stratum *fu* writes 俘, captives or spoils. Western scholarship on the Bronze Age text has adopted or contested the reading line by line.

The three senses—incubation, trust, captivity—compose the novel's moral situation with startling economy. The oracle addresses a captive people. It tells them that something is incubating within their captivity: a truth not yet hatched into fact. And it asks of them trust. *Zhongfu* is at once the name of their condition and the name of its overcoming. Genealogy against provenance here meets its most concentrated case: on Gao Heng's reading, the word for sincerity descends from the word for prisoners of war.

Two of the hexagram's line texts gloss the novel's last scene with uncanny precision. The second line shows a crane calling in the shade and its young answering, followed by a covenant: I have a good goblet; I will share it with you. The *Great Commentary* (*Xici* A.8) reads the line as a doctrine of action at a distance: words well spoken within one's chamber find response beyond a thousand *li*. The image is the oracle's own account of acausal correspondence. The caller is unseen and the answer comes without sight, as the readers of the Pacific States answer a book whose author has abandoned his castle. The top line inverts the image. A cry on wings mounts to heaven—*hanyin*, the *Liji*'s ritual name for the sacrificial cockerel, a barnyard bird whose cry would reach the sky—and persistence brings misfortune. The *Xiang* commentary asks how such a thing could last. The line names fidelity's counterfeit: the cry that rises beyond its substance. In the novel's world the Reich's rockets to Mars are that cry.

11.2 Substance, Stamp, and Backing

Monetary theory offers three answers to the question of what makes a token valuable, and each corresponds to an ontology of worlds.

Theory of value	Source of a token's value	Ontological analogue	Figure in the novel
Metallism	Intrinsic substance: the gold in the coin	A world is real by its facts; truth as correspondence (token-truth)	The Axis world's facts of victory
Chartalism	The issuer's stamp: money as a creature of law (Knapp)	A world is real by certification; truth as provenance	The autographic state; Wyndam-Matson's certificates
Fiduciary theory	Trust honoured over time: money as a claim upon society (Simmel)	A world is real by backing; truth as fidelity of token to type	*Zhongfu*; Frink's jewellery; the Grasshopper

Georg Friedrich Knapp's *Staatliche Theorie des Geldes* (1905) opens with the chartalist axiom, in the words of its English translation (1924): "Money is a creature of law." Georg Simmel's *Philosophie des Geldes* (1900) traced a historical migration of money's value from substance to function, characterised money as a claim upon society, and found in the security that money confers a concentrated expression of confidence in the socio-political order. Medieval theory had already

drawn the political consequence. Nicole Oresme's *De moneta* (c. 1360) held that the coinage belongs to the community, not the prince, and that a ruler who debases it for profit acts as a tyrant.

The novel shows that neither of the first two theories can ground a world. The Axis world possesses every fact of victory; the Reich possesses every certificate; and the oracle declares both false. What the Axis world lacks is backing. It has issued claims—planetary destiny, a thousand-year order, the colonisation of Mars—that no fidelity sustains. In monetary terms it is an inflationary world, and its Inner Truth is its insolvency. The verdict that Germany and Japan lost is an audit, not a report of another world's facts.

The reader's world of 1962 carried all three theories in its wallet. The American dollar was then a silver certificate whose legend read: "This certifies that there is on deposit in the Treasury of the United States of America one dollar in silver payable to the bearer on demand." From the series of 1957 the same note bore the motto that a statute of 1955 had made mandatory on paper currency: "In God We Trust." Certificate and trust were printed on one face. The system behind the note was fiduciary in fact while metallic in law. Robert Triffin's *Gold and the Dollar Crisis* (1960) showed that the reserve currency could supply world liquidity only by multiplying claims its gold could never honour; the London Gold Pool was formed late in 1961 to defend the official price of $35 an ounce. Redemption of silver certificates in silver ended in 1968, and on 15 August 1971 the United States suspended the convertibility of the dollar into gold. The world's money disclosed its fiduciary truth nine years after the novel disclosed the world's.

Jean Baudrillard read the floating of currencies as the emancipation of signs from referential value and the onset of the hyperreal (*L'Échange symbolique et la mort*, 1976). The fiduciary ontology inverts his diagnosis. Baudrillard mourns a gold standard of the real; Dick's novel shows that the gold standard was itself a certificate. Reality never had intrinsic backing, only the fidelity of those who honour it. Fiduciary ontology is therefore not nihilism. It holds that trust is not a substitute for the substance of the real but the substance itself.

11.3 Gresham's Law in the Pacific States

Gresham's law—bad money drives out good—was so named by Henry Dunning Macleod in 1858, though Oresme and Copernicus (*Monetae cudendae ratio*, 1526) had stated it. Where a certificate is the only measure of value and certificates can be forged, the law extends from coin to historicity: counterfeits circulate at the face value of the genuine, and the market loses the capacity to tell them apart. The Pacific States' trade in Americana is such a market. Its crisis comes when Frink and McCarthy, threatening to expose the trade's forgeries, extract capital from Wyndam-Matson; a counterfeit Colt in Childan's own stock is the scheme's proof.

That capital founds the Edfrank workshop. The novel's one authentic art is financed by extortion from the counterfeit industry, and fidelity's capital is laundered from the forgery. Nothing in this world, not even the jewellery that bears *wu*, possesses a clean pedigree. What the jewellery possesses instead is backing. Kasoura's attribution of *wu* functions as an act of acceptance

in the monetary sense: a note honoured without gold. His associate's proposal to mass-produce the design is, in the same idiom, a proposal to print unbacked notes of *wu*, inflating the sign until it purchases nothing.

Dick returned to the monetary index of worlds in *Ubik* (1969), where coins begin to bear the profile of Glen Runciter and so reveal who sustains a world its inhabitants believed to be their own. The coin is where a world's backing becomes visible. In *The Man in the High Castle* that place is the artefact, and the backing it reveals is not a sponsor but a fidelity.

11.4 Three Fidelities

The Reich also claimed fidelity. In 1932 the SS adopted the motto "Meine Ehre heißt Treue" (my honour is loyalty), drawn from a letter of Hitler's of the previous year, and stamped it on its belt buckles. On 2 August 1934 the armed forces were sworn to unconditional obedience to the person of Adolf Hitler. In 1909 Bernhard von Bülow had given the Reichstag the word *Nibelungentreue* for Germany's bond with Austria-Hungary: the loyalty of the Nibelungs, who keep faith until all are destroyed in Etzel's burning hall. On 30 January 1943 Göring compared the encircled Sixth Army at Stalingrad to those Nibelungs. Fidelity so conceived is **fidelity with provenance**: obligation descended from a person, sealed by oath, and grounded in blood. Its eschatology is the burning hall.

Josiah Royce's *The Philosophy of Loyalty* (1908) supplied a universal criterion against it. Royce defined loyalty as "the willing and practical and thoroughgoing devotion of a person to a cause," and he recognised that loyalties can war upon one another. A cause is good, he concluded, only insofar as it furthers loyalty in others; the supreme cause is loyalty to loyalty. By this criterion the novel's most loyal character, Joe Cinnadella, is its most corrupt. His devotion to the Reich is total, and it consumes the fidelity of everyone it touches.

Alain Badiou's *L'Éthique* (1993) restated the distinction in the vocabulary of the event. For Badiou a truth is constituted by a subject's fidelity to an event undecidable within its situation, and it addresses all. Evil takes three forms, the first of which is the simulacrum: fidelity to a pseudo-event that names a particular substance—a people, a soil, a blood—as its subject. Badiou's paradigm of the simulacrum is National Socialism, and its consequence is terror. The SS's *Treue* is the simulacrum of fidelity.

Fidelity without provenance is the novel's third term. Its object is neither a person, as in *Treue*, nor an event, as in Badiou, but the type of the moment—what the oracle names. It requires no oath and no certificate. Its sign is response, as the crane's young answer a call they cannot see. Its criterion is Royce's: it multiplies fidelity in others rather than consuming it. And it often requires the breaking of fidelity with provenance. Wegener, an officer of the Abwehr, whose leaders died at Flossenbürg for their part in the resistance, keeps faith with the world by betraying the Reich.

Wegener's service had its own theorist of this fidelity. At Christmas 1942 Dietrich Bonhoeffer, then working for the Abwehr as cover for the conspiracy, wrote "Nach zehn Jahren" for his closest fellow conspirators; it was published in *Widerstand und Ergebung* (1951). He asked who would stand fast, and he rejected reason, principle, conscience, freedom, and private virtue as sufficient standards. Constancy belonged only to one prepared to sacrifice all of them when called to obedient and responsible action in faith. The oath of 1934 bound the soldier to a person; Bonhoeffer bound the conspirator to responsibility before God for a concrete situation. The novel secularises the second form. Its oracle has no person behind it.

11.5 Making, Refusing, Asking

The ethics is enacted in three acts, each belonging to one of the novel's principal figures of fidelity.

Making. Frink's jewellery belongs to a modern tradition of craft that grounds value in the work rather than the signature. John Ruskin's "The Nature of Gothic" (*The Stones of Venice*, vol. 2, 1853) preferred the free workman's imperfection to the slave's precision: "You must either make a tool of the creature, or a man of him. You cannot make both." Yanagi Sōetsu, who founded the *mingei* (folk craft) movement in the 1920s and died in May 1961, the year Dick wrote the novel, located the beauty of folk craft in the anonymity of the unknown craftsman. In *Bi no hōmon* (1949) he grounded that beauty in the Pure Land doctrine of *tariki*, other-power, against the self-power (*jiriki*) of the individual artist. Kasoura's response to Edfrank is a *mingei* judgment: beauty without signature, value without historicity.

Refusing. Tagomi's withheld signature is a fiduciary act in the strict legal sense. He holds the authority of the Trade Mission in trust, and he refuses to exercise it against the man the form would surrender. Václav Havel's "The Power of the Powerless" (1978) describes a greengrocer who places a regime's slogan in his shop window, not from belief but as a token of compliance, and who begins to live in truth by declining to display it. Tagomi is Havel's greengrocer at the summit of an administration. He declines to issue a counterfeit token.

Asking. Juliana's question treats the truth of the book as a matter of trust rather than certification. Gabriel Marcel's *Du refus à l'invocation* (1940) described fidelity as creative: not the preservation of a past commitment but a renewed response that makes the bond present. Juliana's fidelity is of that kind. She trusts the book beyond its author, and the author is the one who cannot bear what her trust reveals.

William James supplied, in "The Will to Believe" (1896), the social mechanism that makes these acts more than private virtue. A whole train of passengers, he observed, can be looted by a few highwaymen, because the robbers can count on one another while each passenger fears that his resistance will find no support; in such cases "faith in a fact can help create the fact." Occupation has the structure of James's train. The Grasshopper endangers the Reich because it is a

book that, by being trusted, creates the fact it requires: the mutual trust of the occupied. The ban is rational. The book's threat is fiduciary.

11.6 Three Objections

Relativism. If reality is backed by trust, the Reich could manufacture trust and thereby reality. The objection confuses trust with belief. Propaganda can compel belief; it cannot compel trust, which is given and can be withdrawn. Arendt observed that totalitarian propaganda is inseparable from terror and aims not at conviction but at the destruction of the capacity to distinguish fact from fiction. The top line of Hexagram 61 states the same limit in the oracle's idiom: the cry that rises beyond its substance cannot last.

Quietism. Fidelity without provenance might seem to counsel withdrawal into private sincerity. The novel forecloses that reading. Juliana's razor and Tagomi's Colt show that fidelity may act violently, and neither act is sanctified. Tagomi's exhaustion under Hexagram 47 is the price of his fidelity, not its reward. Fidelity is not purity, as Childan's partial turning has already shown.

Mystification. The oracle might seem to reintroduce provenance by another door, as a certificate of last resort. But Chapter 1 established that the oracle's own provenance is impure, and the novel never certifies it. The oracle stands to the novel's worlds as a central bank stands to a fiat currency: an issuer whose notes are honoured only so long as they are trusted. The novel permits its readers to withhold that trust. Abendsen, its own scriptor, comes close to doing so.

11.7 The Fiduciary Ontology Stated

The type–token distinction that Chapter 10 applied to the oracle is Charles Sanders Peirce's. A page of English, Peirce observed, ordinarily contains about twenty tokens of the word "the," while the language contains only one such type ("Prolegomena to an Apology for Pragmaticism," 1906). Peirce had earlier defined truth as "the opinion which is fated to be ultimately agreed to by all who investigate," and the real as the object represented in that opinion ("How to Make Our Ideas Clear," 1878). The fiduciary ontology radicalises Peirce's community of inquiry into a community of fidelity. It can be stated in five propositions.

1. **Backing.** A world is real to the degree that its tokens are backed by fidelity to their types.
2. **Insufficiency.** Neither facts (substance) nor certificates (stamp) suffice for reality; both are present in a counterfeit world.
3. **Inflation.** A world whose claims exceed its backing is inflationary, and its inner truth is its insolvency. The Axis world is such a world.
4. **Task.** Because backing is produced by acts of fidelity, reality is in part a task and not only a given.

5. **Audit.** The oracle certifies no world; it audits every world.

The fourth proposition explains why the novel ends with a departure rather than a revelation. The fifth explains why the reader's world can take no comfort from the verdict. Chapter 12 conducts its audit.

CHAPTER TWELVE

The Empire Never Ended: The Axis Remainder in the Actual

The oracle's audit does not stop at the border of the Axis world. Tagomi has already seen the reader's world and found it ugly, and the historical record shows that the Axis entered the victors' order twice: before the war, as a pupil of its law, and after the war, as a supplier of its science, intelligence, and administration. During the war itself, the reader's world practised classification by descent at home. This chapter argues that the Axis was a token of a type that preceded and survived it, and that the war, decided at the level of event in 1945, remains undecided at the level of type.

12.1 Dick's Late Formula

In *VALIS* (1981) Dick condensed his late gnosis into the axiom that the Empire never ended. The visionary experiences of February and March 1974 had persuaded him that the Rome of the apostolic age and the California of the Nixon administration were a single time, and that the Black Iron Prison of imperial domination persisted beneath the apparent discontinuities of history. In "How to Build a Universe That Doesn't Fall Apart Two Days Later" (1978) he argued that societies saturated with counterfeit realities produce counterfeit persons, and that the counterfeit is an instrument of power.

The formula is the late, explicit form of the synchronic counterfactual. Two times are copresent, and a type—empire—persists across tokens that differ in every particular. *The Man in the High Castle* already contains the formula in the form of an audit. Tagomi's vision in Portsmouth Square is its first instance: the Allied world, entered through a koan, proves to be a world in which the Empire has also not ended.

Dick's abandoned sequel, two chapters of which were published posthumously (Dick 1995), would have returned to the Reich, and Dick attributed its abandonment to the SS diary he had read at Berkeley (Chapter 3). The failure is instructive. The Axis remainder could not be represented from within the Axis mind. It could be represented only as an audit of the actual.

12.2 Before the Token: The American Model

The autographic type preceded the Reich, and part of its genealogy runs through the law of the reader's world. James Q. Whitman's *Hitler's American Model* (2017) documents that the jurists who prepared the Nuremberg Laws studied American race law: the anti-miscegenation statutes of some thirty states and the race-based immigration and naturalisation law of the federal government. At a meeting of the commission for the reform of criminal law on 5 June 1934, Roland Freisler and his colleagues discussed American practice at length. Whitman shows that they found the American one-drop rule too severe for their own purposes.

Hitler's *Mein Kampf* praised the United States for excluding immigrants on grounds of health and race, a policy codified in the national-origins quotas of the Immigration Act of 1924. The German sterilisation law of 14 July 1933, under which hereditary health courts ordered the sterilisation of some 400,000 people, drew on the model statute drafted by Harry H. Laughlin in 1922, a version of which the Supreme Court upheld in *Buck v. Bell* (1927). Justice Holmes's opinion sustained the compulsory sterilisation of Carrie Buck with the sentence "Three generations of imbeciles are enough." Heidelberg awarded Laughlin an honorary doctorate in 1936. American states went on to sterilise more than 60,000 people under laws of this kind, and at Nuremberg the circuit closed: in the Doctors' Trial Karl Brandt's counsel quoted a German translation of Holmes's opinion, other defendants cited it, and it appeared again in the defence exhibit "Race Protection Laws of Other Countries" (Lombardo 2008).

These continuities do not make the American and German regimes equivalent; Whitman's argument concerns models and borrowings, not identity. They establish the dissertation's narrower claim. The Reich was not the origin of the autographic type but its most extreme token, and the type had other tokens in the victors' own legal order.

12.3 During the Token: Tagomi's America

Tagomi's vision is the chapter's first datum, and the record of the reader's world bears it out. On 19 February 1942 President Roosevelt signed Executive Order 9066. Under it the Army's Western Defense Command, led by General John L. DeWitt, ordered every person of Japanese ancestry out of the West Coast military zones, and some 120,000 people were held in camps, most of them run by the War Relocation Authority; about two-thirds were American citizens. The order classified persons by descent alone. In this dissertation's terms it was an autographic measure, taken by the democracy at war with the autographic state.

The Supreme Court upheld the exclusion in *Korematsu v. United States* (1944). Four decades later the reader's world began to back its victory with acts. In 1983 a federal court vacated Fred Korematsu's conviction. The Civil Liberties Act of 1988 apologised on behalf of the nation and paid $20,000 to each surviving incarceree. In 2018 the Supreme Court declared that

Korematsu "was gravely wrong the day it was decided" (*Trump v. Hawaii*). On the fiduciary ontology these are payments against a debt, made long after it was incurred.

The year of the novel belonged to the same order. In 1962 racial segregation was still law across much of the American South. The sit-ins that began at a Woolworth's lunch counter in Greensboro, North Carolina, on 1 February 1960 had made the segregated lunch counter the emblem of that order, and in September and October 1962 federal marshals and troops were required to enrol James Meredith at the University of Mississippi. The lunch counter at which Tagomi is denied the deference of his rank is the lunch counter of the actual.

12.4 After the Token: The Remainder

The second continuity runs from the defeat of 1945 into the postwar order. The victors absorbed Axis personnel, knowledge, and administrative cadres, chiefly for reasons of Cold War utility. The record is extensive; the instances below bear directly on the novel's themes of technics, intelligence, provenance law, and the Japanese state.

Person or programme	Role under the Axis	Role in the victors' order
Wernher von Braun and the Paperclip specialists	Von Braun was the V-2 programme's technical director, an NSDAP member from 1937 and an SS member from 1940. The rocket was built by concentration-camp prisoners under SS administration, an estimated 20,000 of whom died in the Mittelbau-Dora camps	More than 1,600 German specialists brought to the United States; Saturn V and Apollo
Arthur Rudolph	Production director at Mittelwerk, where the prisoners worked	Saturn V programme manager; left the United States in 1984 rather than contest Justice Department charges that he took part in the persecution of Mittelwerk's forced labourers
Reinhard Gehlen	Head of Wehrmacht intelligence on the Eastern Front	Ran a US-sponsored network, staffed in part by former SS and SD officers, that became the West German BND (president 1956–68)
Klaus Barbie	Gestapo chief in Lyon. In April 1944 he ordered the deportation of 44 Jewish children from the children's home at Izieu, all of whom were murdered; the resistance leader Jean Moulin died in 1943 after torture under his interrogation	Employed by the US Army Counter Intelligence Corps (1947–51), which helped him reach Bolivia; expelled to France in 1983 and convicted of crimes against humanity in 1987
Hans Globke	Co-author of the official commentary on the Nuremberg Laws (1936); formulated the 1938 ordinance on Jewish names	Head of Adenauer's Federal Chancellery (1953–63)
Reinhard Höhn	SS jurist and SD official; theorist of administration	Founded the Bad Harzburg academy for business managers (1956)

Person or programme	Role under the Axis	Role in the victors' order
Ishii Shirō and Unit 731	Imperial Japanese Army unit in Manchuria that killed prisoners, most of them Chinese, in experiments that included deliberate infection with plague and other diseases (at least 3,000 at its Pingfang complex alone), and that spread plague in attacks on Chinese cities, among them Ningbo (1940) and Changde (1941)	Granted immunity by US occupation authorities in exchange for research data; the Soviet Union tried twelve Japanese servicemen connected with the programme at Khabarovsk (1949)
Kishi Nobusuke	A principal planner of Manchukuo's industrialisation, which relied on Chinese forced labour; Minister of Commerce and Industry under Tōjō and co-signatory of the declaration of war	Released from Sugamo without trial (1948); Prime Minister 1957–60

Globke's case touches the novel at its centre. As an official of the Reich Interior Ministry he formulated the ordinance of 17 August 1938 and its implementing regulations, under which Jews whose given names did not appear on an approved list were obliged to assume, by 1 January 1939, the additional name "Israel" or "Sara" (Konrad-Adenauer-Stiftung n.d.; EHRI n.d.). The ordinance made passing by name impossible. Frank Frink's survival depends on precisely the act it was designed to prevent. In the reader's world, while Dick was writing, the man who formulated it directed the chancellery of the victors' principal continental ally. In April 1961, as the Eichmann trial opened in Jerusalem, East German television broadcast a documentary indictment of his career, *Aktion J* (USHMM n.d.).

The Federal Ministry of Justice displayed the same continuity at scale. The independent commission that examined its files reported in 2016 that 53 per cent of the 170 senior officials it studied had belonged to the NSDAP, and that the proportion peaked in 1957 at 77 per cent (Görtemaker and Safferling 2016). The ministry charged with the law of the new republic was staffed, at the height of Adenauer's chancellorship, predominantly by the old regime's party members. A later study of the Federal Prosecutor's Office found that in 1953 twenty-two of its twenty-eight senior lawyers had belonged to the NSDAP (LTO 2019).

Kishi's case touches the novel by name. Tagomi's given name is Nobusuke. The novel's righteous official shares it with the minister who co-signed Japan's declaration of war, was held as a Class A war-crimes suspect, and in 1960—the year before Dick wrote—forced the revised US–Japan Security Treaty through the Diet amid the largest protests in Japan's postwar history. Whether Dick intended the echo cannot be documented. It is treated here, like the translator's birth name in Chapter 1, as a synchronicity, and it is the onomastic form of the chapter's claim: the Axis world's virtue and the actual world's remainder bear the same name.

The occupation of Japan traced the same arc. After 1947 the "reverse course" (*gyaku kōsu*) turned American policy from demilitarisation and democratisation toward anti-communism, halting the dissolution of the *zaibatsu* and rehabilitating purged officials. The Emperor in whose name the war had been fought was never prosecuted.

12.5 Two Victors Fall Out

The novel's three worlds share a postwar type. In each, the victors of the war divide the world and turn on one another.

World	Victors	Postwar rivalry	Instrument of the next war
The Axis world (W1)	Germany and Japan	The Reich against the Japanese empire	Operation Dandelion, a planned nuclear strike on the Home Islands
The Grasshopper's world (W2)	Britain and the United States	The British Empire against the United States	An Anglo-American cold war for markets
The reader's world (W0)	The United States, the Soviet Union, Britain	The United States against the Soviet Union	Thermonuclear deterrence

The type is invariant; only the tokens differ. Dick wrote in the year the Berlin Wall was built, and the novel appeared in the year of the Cuban missile crisis. Herman Kahn's *On Thermonuclear War* (1960) had already made the calculation of megadeaths an instrument of policy. Operation Dandelion is the Axis token of a type the reader's world was then instantiating.

The fiction and cinema of the following decade made the Axis remainder in the victors' order explicit. Stanley Kubrick's *Dr. Strangelove* (1964) placed a former German scientist in the American war room, his right arm rising in a salute he cannot suppress. Thomas Pynchon's *Gravity's Rainbow* (1973) followed the V-2 into the Zone of occupied Germany, imagined the war as the instrument of a transnational cartel indifferent to which side won, and ended with a rocket poised above a Los Angeles cinema. Kurt Vonnegut's *Mother Night*, which appeared within months of Dick's novel, supplies the autographic counter-case. Its narrator, Howard W. Campbell Jr., is an American agent whose cover was the broadcasting of Nazi propaganda. His provenance as a spy absolves him in law but not in truth, and Vonnegut's moral is that we become what we pretend to be. Campbell possesses provenance without fidelity. Frink possesses fidelity without provenance.

12.6 Undecided at the Level of Type

In his 1959 lecture "Was bedeutet: Aufarbeitung der Vergangenheit," Theodor Adorno judged the survival of National Socialism within democracy potentially more menacing than the survival of fascist tendencies against democracy. Karl Jaspers's *Die Schuldfrage* (1946) had distinguished criminal, political, moral, and metaphysical guilt, and it assigned the last to all who survived crimes they did not prevent. Both positions refuse the consolation that the defeat of the Reich settled the question of fascism.

The fiduciary ontology locates that refusal precisely. The war was decided at the level of token in 1945. At the level of type—the autographic state, the demiurgic will to remake the world by technique, the colonial imaginary of racial space—it was not. The reader's world possesses what the Axis world lacks: tokens of the type's defeat. Raphael Lemkin coined the word *genocide* in a book entitled *Axis Rule in Occupied Europe* (1944), the very condition Dick projected onto America. The International Military Tribunal at Nuremberg (1945–46), the Genocide Convention (9 December 1948), and the Universal Declaration of Human Rights (10 December 1948) are such tokens.

On the fiduciary ontology, however, tokens are real only to the degree that they are backed. The instruments of 1945–48 are notes issued against a fidelity that the record of Paperclip, Globke, the Rosenburg, and Kishi shows to have been partial. The reader's world is therefore not the Axis world. It is a world whose victory remains to be backed. This is the precise sense in which the oracle's verdict is a summons rather than a consolation. Read in the Axis world, "Germany and Japan lost" is an audit of insolvency. Read in the reader's world, it is a debt.

The *taijitu* gives the result its form. The Axis world carries the seed of its opposite in *The Grasshopper Lies Heavy*. The reader's world carries the seed of the Axis in its own field: in its law before the war, in its exclusions by descent during it, in its science, intelligence, and ministries after it, and in the freeway that Tagomi sees from Portsmouth Square.

12.7 The Adaptation as Symptom

The television adaptation produced for Amazon (2015–19) offers a final piece of evidence. It replaced Abendsen's novel with newsreel films of other worlds, among them footage of the reader's actual history, and in its later seasons it introduced a machine that carries travellers physically between worlds. Both changes reverse the novel's form. Type-truth becomes documentary token-truth: the films prove what happened elsewhere. Acausal correspondence becomes causal transit: the portal replaces the oracle.

The changes are intelligible as choices of genre and medium. They are also symptomatic. The culture of the actual found the novel's crux—a book false in fact and true in type—intolerable, and it resolved the crux by restoring provenance: the film as certificate, the portal as passage. The adaptation re-diachronised the synchronic counterfactual, and in doing so it confirmed this chapter's claim. The reader's world remains an autographic world, and the verdict of Hexagram 61 is addressed to it.

CONCLUSION

Wind over Lake

The novel ends with an answer that changes nothing visible. No army moves and no regime falls; the world into which Juliana walks out is the world from which she walked in. Hexagram 61 names the only mode in which such an answer can act: wind over a lake, invisible in itself and visible only in the movement it raises on the water. This dissertation has argued that the image is the novel's theory of its own efficacy, and that the theory amounts to a new conception of how worlds relate, what makes them real, and what can be asked of those who live in them.

I. Results

The argument has established four results, corresponding to the propositions of the Introduction.

1. **Form.** *The Man in the High Castle* inaugurates the synchronic counterfactual. Its worlds relate not only through a causal hinge in a shared past but through acausal correspondences in a shared present. The oracle's knowledge of other worlds is knowledge of transworld types, and the novel's crux dissolves once type-truth is distinguished from token-truth (Chapter 10).
2. **Politics.** The novel identifies fascism with the autographic state, which constitutes persons and things through provenance, and it exposes that state as parasitic on the counterfeit it claims to exclude—from the *Protocols* to Operation Bernhard, from Wyndam-Matson's lighters to the extradition order for Frink (Chapter 5).
3. **Ontology and ethics.** Against provenance the novel sets fidelity. Worlds are real as fiduciary money is valuable: by backing, not by substance or stamp. The corresponding ethics is fidelity without provenance, enacted in making, refusing, and asking (Chapter 11).
4. **History and theology.** The oracle certifies no world. Its verdict is an audit of the Axis world and a debt for the reader's world, in which the Axis type was present before the war and persisted after its defeat (Chapter 12). The novel is a negative theodicy.

The study has also proposed instruments that may prove useful beyond Dick: the method of genealogy against provenance (Prefatory Note); the distinction between demiurgic and

anamnestic gnosis (Chapter 3); the aspecular *mise en abyme*, in which an embedded work mirrors a third world rather than the one that contains it (Chapter 7); synchronic grace, a providence without a provider (Chapter 8); and synchronistic modal realism, which joins Lewis's causally isolated worlds to Jung's acausal meaning (Chapter 10).

II. Negative Theodicy

Leibniz ended the *Theodicy* in the Palace of the Fates, where Theodorus faints before the beauty of the best of possible worlds. Hegel ended the philosophy of history in the court of world history, where success is judgment. Voltaire answered Leibniz with an earthquake, in the *Poème sur le désastre de Lisbonne* (1756) and in *Candide* (1759). Adorno would observe in *Negative Dialektik* (1966) that the Lisbon earthquake had sufficed to cure Voltaire of Leibniz's theodicy, and that after Auschwitz no affirmative metaphysics of meaning could stand.

Dick's novel belongs to this negative tradition and adds to it a positive remainder. Its theodicy is negative because it justifies no world. The Axis world is declared false. The Allied world of the Grasshopper is false in its facts. The reader's world, seen from Portsmouth Square, is ugly and carries the Axis seed. What the novel justifies is acts: a jewel made, a signature withheld, a question asked. Theodorus faints before the apex of the pyramid; Juliana walks out of the house. The distance between the two endings is the distance between a theodicy of worlds and an ethics of fidelity.

III. Coda: Generated Worlds

Two further genealogies close the study. The first joins the castle to the oracle. Kurt Wolff, who published Kafka's *Das Schloss* in Munich in 1926, emigrated to New York and founded Pantheon Books, which issued the Wilhelm–Baynes *I Ching* as Bollingen Series XIX in 1950. His son, the composer Christian Wolff, gave a copy to John Cage, who used it to compose *Music of Changes* (1951), among the first works of Western music written by consulting the oracle at every juncture. Abendsen's method had a public precedent a decade before the novel. The castle that K. never reaches and the oracle that discloses the castle's emptiness reached their readers through the same publisher.

The second joins the novel to the present. Literature had long imagined books produced by chance—from the engine at the Academy of Lagado in *Gulliver's Travels* (1726), which generates sentences by random permutation, to Borges's Library of Babel—but chiefly as satire or as nightmare. *The Grasshopper Lies Heavy* is the first such book a fiction declares true, and Juliana's question is a prototype of interrogating a generative process about its own product. Six decades later, systems that generate text, images, and voices by statistical process have made Wyndam-Matson's lighters the general condition of evidence. The dominant institutional response is autographic: since 2021 the Coalition for Content Provenance and Authenticity has developed standards that bind media to cryptographically signed records of origin. The argument of this

dissertation does not reject such measures, but it predicts their limit. A regime that grounds truth in provenance is parasitic on the forgery it excludes, and a certificate can be forged as readily as the object it certifies.

The novel also anticipates the opposite error. Statistical plausibility—the shape of truth without its fidelity—is the cockerel's cry of the top line of Hexagram 61: a sound that rises beyond its substance and cannot last. A generated text can be plausible in type and false in token, as the Grasshopper is; what generation alone cannot supply is the fidelity that made the Grasshopper true. Between the certificate and the plausible, the novel locates truth where it located value: in backing, sustained by communities of response that can audit what they are given and can withdraw their trust.

IV. Limits and Further Research

The study has confined itself to one novel and has drawn on Dick's later work only where it illuminates the earlier. Four lines of further research follow from it. The first concerns the *Exegesis* and the sequel fragments, which may show how far Dick himself understood the oracle's verdict as an audit of the actual. The second concerns the novel's Japanese reception and its relation to the alternate-war fiction (*kakū senki*) that flourished in Japan in the 1990s, in which the Pacific War is refought from the side of the defeated. The third concerns gender. Juliana's role as querent exceeds the oracular type, but Dick's women remain disproportionately the bearers of revelations that change men, and the Sophia of the later work invites a more critical reading than Chapter 9 has offered. The fourth concerns the fiduciary ontology itself, which requires fuller formalisation and comparison with social ontologies of collective acceptance (Searle 1995) and with the epistemology of testimony.

V. Wind over Lake

The image of Hexagram 61 is the dissertation's last word because it is the novel's. Heraclitus said of the lord whose oracle is at Delphi that he "neither utters nor hides his meaning, but shows it by a sign" (DK B93, trans. Burnet). Wind over a lake is such a sign. Wind cannot be seen; only the lake shows that it passes. The reader cannot see the world in which the Grasshopper is true; only the movement it raises in those who read it shows that it is there. Juliana, Tagomi, Frink, and even Childan in his partial turning are the surface of the water. The novel asks its reader to become one more such surface—not to verify the wind, which cannot be done, but to keep faith with it.

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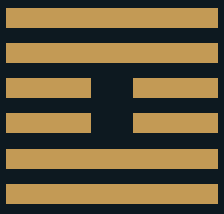
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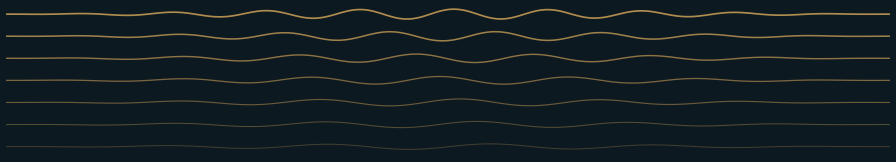
Keywords

Philip K. Dick · *The Man in the High Castle* · alternate history · uchronia · counterfactual history · synchronic counterfactual · Jonbar hinge · *I Ching* (*Yijing*) · Hexagram 61 (*Zhongfu*, Inner Truth) · synchronicity · C. G. Jung · Richard Wilhelm · Gottfried Wilhelm Leibniz · theodicy · negative theodicy · possible worlds · modal realism · synchronistic modal realism · type–token distinction · Daoism · *wu wei* · Zen Buddhism · koan · *wu* · authenticity · forgery · historicity · aura · autographic and allographic arts · Nelson Goodman · Walter Benjamin · autographic state · provenance · fiduciary ontology · fidelity without provenance · trust (*fides*, *fu*) · National Socialism · totalitarianism · Hannah Arendt · colonialism · Aimé Césaire · colonial mimicry · Gnosticism · Eric Voegelin · metafiction · *mise en abyme* · aspecular *mise en abyme* · historiographic metafiction · philosophy of history · Friedrich Nietzsche · Cold War · Operation Paperclip · postwar continuity · synthetic media · content provenance · science fiction studies · comparative literature



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